ARCHITECT GUIDE TO RELATIONSHIPS

Improve romantic partnerships, friendships, and parent-child relationships

16Personalities

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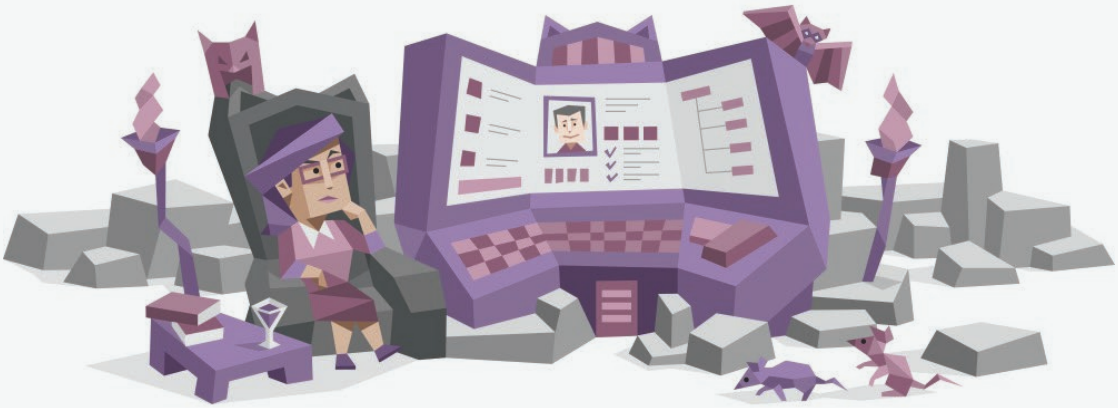

Introduction

Why Relationships Matter to Architects

Personal relationships might not always seem like one of life's biggest priorities to Architects, yet they're an intrinsic part of life, even for these independent personality types. Ideas germinate in different, essential ways when shared with others, and Architects often find that many of their goals in life aren't solitary ones. Sometimes great joy waits in the company of other, like-minded souls. However, navigating the path to such rewards isn't always easy for these rationalistic tacticians.

Beneath their confidence and certainty, Architects aren't without their vulnerabilities. The world of emotions – as unpredictable, uncontrollable, and illogical as it is – can pose issues for them. Whether they're navigating friendships, romantic relationships, or parenting and family responsibilities, Architects may have difficulty identifying and honoring their own emotions, let alone those of others. As a result, they sometimes suppress their true feelings, avoid meaningful but emotional conversations, and struggle to express compassion and affection toward those they love.

Yet they're far from doomed when it comes to relationships. Their authenticity and insight enable them to forge deep, intentional connections instead of losing themselves in superficial acquaintanceships. To further strengthen their personal bonds, Architects can work to expand their emotional intelligence. Rather than dismissing emotions as inconvenient or insignificant, they can learn to appreciate the value of gut instinct, the power of expressing love and gratitude, and the surprising efficacy of just being there for

loved ones who are struggling. This mindset allows Architects to bring their greatest strengths to their relationships, helping them connect with their close-knit circle of friends and loved ones who add genuine value to their lives.

So, let's begin our exploration of Architect relationships in several key forms. Each of these chapters may feel more relevant in different moments or periods of life, yet all of them are critical areas of the human experience worthy of the focused attention of the Architect mind. Some of life's most powerful rewards are those that are generated with others, and there are many exciting ways that Architects' traits can play off the traits of other personality types. For Architects, uncovering these potentials in their own way can be a satisfying journey.

Want to know more about your personality traits and the theory behind them? You can dive in here.

Romantic Relationships

It's easy to stereotype those with the Thinking trait, including Architects, as lacking a romantic side, but their emphasis on rationality and knowledge doesn't mean these bookish types are robotic people incapable of romance. While it's true that Architects don't easily express their feelings in conventional ways, interpreting this characteristic as a lack of passion misses the whole truth: underneath their preference for reason over emotions, powerful feelings still flow.

Loyal and Quietly Passionate

Connectedness is an essential human need, and romantic love is among its strongest expressions. When the right people respond to Architects, they're models of loving stability. They identify themselves as enjoying the fewest long-term relationships of any type, suggesting a tendency to be selective, remain loyal, and commit to a romantic partner for the long haul. But not everyone expresses love in the same way, and Architects tend to defy the conventions that surround dating, love, and marriage.

Their unique style may create superficial hurdles their lovers must overcome before Architects get to the point of making a loyal commitment. For them, however, it's more about style and expression than substance. Architects aren't known as emotionally demonstrative people. They don't express themselves "from the heart" with a flourish as easily as other types. They're one of the personality types least comfortable hugging their friends or talking about their feelings. Architects also experience awkwardness when

trying to express emotions or when partners talk about their personal feelings. Before their lovers get to know them, they may misinterpret Architects' discomfort as coldness or an aloof attitude, as they often cope with stress by withdrawing. Potential romantic partners may need time and effort to decipher Architects' sometimes-enigmatic approach to love.

However, once Architects find partners they're ready to commit to, and when they allow themselves to express their feelings, the bonds between them grow firm. Their calm reserve can conceal their passion, which manifests when they let down their guard. Even after they commit, Architects aren't showy; their relationships aren't known for emotional fireworks. Yet quiet romances often contain great depths – feelings often downplayed or even suppressed may emerge in the right moments. Architects' commitment and dedication often surprise partners who persevere.

Finding a Lighter Touch

Young Architects, still discovering who they are, may find that their self-confidence takes major hits during awkward dating experiences. Although "romance" – with its rituals and intangible realities – is a skill that can be learned, it isn't the most natural mindset for Architects. "Because it feels right," is rarely a convincing argument for them. After a while, they can grow discouraged from trying to force such emotional matters as mating into the systematic frameworks they prefer, which causes them to occasionally put their dating lives on the back burner. When it comes to matters of the heart, Architects are often late bloomers, as they must get past the idea that sometimes none of it makes sense – or, at least, not the kind of sense they're used to.

In new dating opportunities, Architects may try to counteract social awkwardness by showing off their more rational bent. Though they're just playing to their strengths, a relentlessly factual tone can make a dull first impression with new people. In fact, it can come off as brash and condescending, with a "know-it-all" undercurrent. After enough such uncomfortable outings, Architects may decide they just aren't good at dating.

The good news is that experience and maturity can turn such awkward phases into opportunities for social growth. Although their more precise, rational style is one of their greater assets, experience can teach Architects that their heavier approach is a currency that not everyone values equally. Learning to use a lighter touch around people can be one of their more important life lessons, especially when it comes to dating. It's OK just to have fun on a date.

Analysis and the Language of Love

Once Architects begin dating prospective partners, they may stall their romances with analysis out of a desire for certainty, turning the joyful experience of newfound love into a clinical examination. Although their knee-jerk reaction is to develop clear, rational direction for their budding relationships, risk and doubt are nearly always a part of love. Hearts are broken every day. Learning to take chances and enjoy partners in the present – instead of trying to understand and control matters of the heart – is a good place for Architects to start. A naturally unfolding romance needs its own timetable.

Architects spend much of their lives in their heads, and they find it challenging to square their imaginative expectations with hard reality. They're among the personality types most likely to say that their attitudes about relationships frequently change; they are constantly asking, "Is there a perfect, rational formula for love?" Even if they believe they've found one, with more data their formula might transform completely – their wishes are sometimes a moving target.

Architects don't always appreciate the rituals involved in courtship and often regard them as arbitrary. For example, they don't see the logic behind waiting a certain number of hours before returning a text; if Architects are interested in pursuing romance, dispatching quick replies after their first dates seems like an efficient and honest communication of their interest. It might not occur to them that overeager new suitors can make some people nervous – and often they realize this only after chasing off a few love interests. Rituals often have purposes related more to emotional intelligence than strict rationality, and Architects who reject such rituals may struggle to find lovers who are "entirely logical."

Fewer Solutions, More Empathy

Architects in love struggle with their desire to analyze and solve every perceived problem. They don't realize that many individuals aren't always looking for solutions – sometimes they just need a sympathetic ear. Architects see pain and try to "fix" it, and they are the type most likely to agree with the statement, "You believe there's a right or wrong answer to every question in life." For them, there's a definitive solution for every problem. Everything is a part of a system that, if broken, just needs rethinking or readjusting to be repaired.

Architects who want to support their mates need to show sympathy. Without it, they may create a sense of emotional disconnection that can fall hard on their already hurting partners. Sympathy includes intentional listening, with a focus on understanding rather than problem-solving. It's hard for this analytical personality type to achieve, but with focus and a desire to improve, it's possible to achieve a greater sense of both sympathy and intimacy with their romantic partners.

Potential Pairings

Knowing What They're Looking For

Although their definition of satisfying romantic relationships may be ever-evolving, Architects tend to make specific checklists of traits they want in their hypothetical sweethearts. They know what they want, and they keep their strict criteria realistic but precise. They aren't likely to place physical attractiveness, social status, or communication skills at the top of their lists of desired attributes, instead homing in on rationality, wisdom, trustworthiness, and reliability. They tend to reject those they perceive as shallow or uninteresting people. Architects are among the types most likely to prefer partners with similar interests versus those who add variety to their lives.

Partners who find romantic and even seductive appeal to their ideas are preferable to Architects looking for love. Some personality types might judge this criterion as odd or unromantic, but as the saying goes, there's a cover for every pot. It might take a little digging to find the qualities they search for in their partners, but mature Architects take the time to get to know others, understanding that initial impressions aren't always representative of true personality.

Compromise and Balance

Architects are by no means the only personality type with lofty expectations of their future partners and relationships. Although it's certainly beneficial to keep a set of traits in mind when looking for their special someone, Architects should avoid becoming "married" to their idea of an ideal mate (pun intended). All relationships are built on compromise, and people are unique and complex; it's impossible to find lovers that fit the exact molds Architects can imagine. It's unrealistic to think that their sweethearts will share all their interests and beliefs. Having "enough" in common is often more enriching, anyway, as their partners can introduce them to new ideas as well.

It's also not necessarily wise to judge potential partners based on their perceived intelligence. Knowledge manifests itself in a variety of ways, and although individuals may not be as well-versed in the same things they are, Architects shouldn't discount the importance of other forms of intelligence. For instance, lovers with a gift for the language of feelings can help to balance out some of the weaker areas of Architects' personality by helping them improve their emotional intelligence. Likewise, potential companions skilled in mechanical or artistic endeavors can provide the skills and know-how to implement ideas that Architects can only ponder. The best partners balance one another's traits and bring out the best in each other.

Simple Guidelines

There are enough similarities between each trait's attributes that we can provide an overview of how certain features may interact with others – the potential positives and negatives of those pairings. Different Architects find different traits attractive. For example, some Architects appreciate having Introverted partners who encourage them to reflect and relax, whereas others choose Extraverts with similar interests who prefer getting out of the house or entertaining friends rather than spending quiet evenings at home. Individual Architects may seek out Feeling partners who can help bring out their more submerged emotions, whereas others appreciate Thinking partners who match their more rational thought processes. In other words, there's no set formula for the needs and wants of the heart.

It's important to remember that people are unique, and what is right for some Architects may not be true for others. Adding further uncertainty and excitement to this concept is the fact that people display trait attributes in slightly different ways. Not all Intuitive types, for example, use their Intuition in the same way, just as not all Extraverts show their Extraversion in the same way. Personality type characteristics fall within a continuum: within our assessment, it's possible for individuals to score 90% Introverted, or 52% Introverted – and both scores represent Introverted people. Individuals express traits differently depending on where they fall on that continuum.

Architect-Analyst Relationships

People often say that "opposites attract," as if human hearts were emotional magnets. If that's true, it's fortunate that no two people are exactly alike, even if they share the same essential personality traits. Romances between Architects and other Analysts are hardly like peering into a mirror. Rest assured, even with their similarities, there remain plenty of nuances and differences to keep these relationships exciting.

Balanced Architect-Analyst Relationships

Intellectually Stimulated

When Architects and other Analysts bond romantically, they favor intellectual rather than emotional stimulation. It's worth repeating that this doesn't indicate an absence of emotions or passion. But neither Architects nor their Analyst lovers find expressing their feelings to be their strong suits, and they can feel uncomfortable – maybe even disoriented – in emotionally charged situations. They value their rational abilities, but they're not always as attentive to their emotional intelligence.

Architects and their Analyst lovers connect deeply over stimulating conversations and common interests. At dinner together, these couples often forgo small talk or a review of their day; instead, their discussions might focus on big ideas and hypothetical scenarios. Depending on their Analyst partners, these conversations can touch on almost any topic, from the wonders of the cosmos to intricacies on the atomic level. These couples may regard their meetings of the mind as refuges from the comparatively insignificant world they interact with outside of their relationships.

A Unique Partnership

Architects in love with other Analysts can be loyal, responsible, stimulating partners. They grow together when they focus on expanding their comfort zones, and their shared Intuitive trait is likely to provide them with an openness that has them readily exploring alternatives to their own experience. Together, they're likely to ask a lot of "what if" questions – for which Architects are happy to provide thorough analyses in response.

Architect-Analyst couples aren't likely to care whether they fit the pop-culture version of what falling in love looks like, and that's a good thing, as these lovers may not appear conventional. They adore systems, puzzles, and other things that may not play a central role with most other couples. As they try to outdo each other in a spirited debate, they may even look overly competitive. Although it may not be how popular entertainment portrays loving relationships, it doesn't diminish their validity or the strength of their bond. In fact, Analysts are likely to see their unique take on romance as one more thing that distinguishes their love.

Unbalanced Architect-Analyst Relationships

Overly Reliant on the Rational

Typically, Architects and other Analysts come to romantic relationships with a list of expectations. They may expect their partners to always behave logically, especially if they're similar types. Architects and their sweethearts can struggle to find rationales for their love or affection, instead of accepting that their feelings may exist outside

of their conscious understanding or control. They can hobble their relationships by not recognizing that the people they love won't always fulfill every item on their preconceived checklists. When these lovers act irrationally – as all humans do at times – resorting to quick judgments can let both partners down.

Architects and other Analysts typically have difficulty reading other people's emotions. Their rigorous minds also continually seek areas for improvement. Because of this, these couples can be at risk of nitpicking their relationships in pursuit of improvement. This can become especially difficult if they extend this to "improving" the people they love; trying to "improve" romantic partners rarely bodes well for relationships. Without some awareness, the risk is that they'll spend more time assessing and deconstructing their relationships than experiencing them – let alone enjoying them.

There's no inherent problem with romantic relationships being "intellectual" and "analytical" rather than emotional. However, Architect-Analyst romantic partners, in all their rationality, can still hurt each other's feelings. These couples only make matters worse when they square off with logical arguments instead of offering each other sympathy when there's pain rather than a rational problem to solve.

"Big Picture" Over Practical Planners

Although it's worth taking the time to reflect on where the future may lead, few things in life are clear-cut. When people with distinct styles share the decision-making process, things become even murkier. Architects can be prone to overthink their decisions, and they may lead their Analyst partners down a rabbit hole of paying painful attention to things that really don't matter. While reading a recipe, they are apt to ask, "How can they write, 'pinch of salt?' How can a recipe use that inaccurate measure? Isn't it relative?"

These romantic partners feel utterly paralyzed when they face situations that don't provide enough information to predict how a certain scenario will likely play out. Similar problems arise when all available options are imperfect. Should they take a risk and move to another state or country in search of better opportunities? It's easy to imagine Architects and their Analyst partners spending countless

evenings researching, brainstorming, and pacing back and forth in the dining room, nitpicking arguments for and against a move like this for hours without ever coming to a decision. This doesn't apply exclusively to major life decisions: a Saturday trip to a national park can have all the joy sucked out of it if these couples can't learn to relax their mental muscles long enough to commit to a plan and dive into the experience.

Rebalancing Architect-Analyst Relationships

Analyzing Isn't the Same as Appreciating

Simply appreciating their partners, rather than analyzing them or their relationships, can strengthen love. People are tremendously complex, and even the most astute Architects and Analysts may never fully understand everything about their lovers – but that doesn't matter. The strength of romantic relationships comes from enjoying partners as they are, not from figuring them out. These rational couples may find it helpful to permit themselves to spend time in ambiguity, no matter how uncomfortable that might be initially.

Architects and other Analysts may not be fluent in the language of the heart, but it doesn't mean they shouldn't attempt to talk about their feelings. Assuming too much has its hazards, and asking questions out of genuine concern can be healing. Architects need a willingness to accept the answers they're given at face value. To avoid either overanalyzing or mind-reading, Architects and their Analyst partners may want to consider communication as collecting data, not for analysis or a solution, but simply for awareness. This distinction is likely important for these couples. Here are a few ways they can build awareness:

- Experimenting with spontaneity can be the most obvious, direct way to confront the tendency to overanalyze relationships.
    - One way to explore spontaneity would be for each partner to plan a surprise date each month, with only the day and time agreed to beforehand.
    - Rather than ruminating and discussing the endless details, one partner plans an evening or day with only two requirements:

(1) to bring enjoyment to their significant other and (2) that the event holds an element of surprise.

  - The other partner should agree ahead of time to go along "spontaneously." This bypasses the possibility of over-analysis and builds trust – something all couples need to thrive.

- Find and use a feelings chart (there are many available online).
  - As a couple, pick a time of day or day of the week, and point out emotions felt during the day or week.
  - Keep in mind that feelings don't always have to be explained or even "fixed." Awareness of what each partner is experiencing can be all that a relationship needs at times.

Taking time to just "be" occasionally, and an attitude that's accepting of their partners' differences, can help Architects keep their relationships healthy. No matter how analytical their approaches to life are, feelings come and go in the most spontaneous way for most. Learning to accept them – rather than manipulate or control them – can help Architect-Analyst couples grow closer.

Prioritizing Practical Needs

Architects are among the more organized of the Analysts, but they're still heavily influenced by interior, "big picture" thinking, and daily tasks may fall to the wayside at times. It's not that they disregard details as much as they're selective about those they emphasize. A systematic list of chores and household deadlines can be helpful to make sure these couples take care of life's nagging details that might fall off the radar and ensure they divide responsibilities fairly. Placing a priority on everyday tasks may not be something that Architects and other Analysts are eager to do, but the health of their relationship may depend on it. This is particularly the case for finances, as arguments over money can harm almost any relationship.

Analysts worthy of the designation have the potential for creating efficient systems for maintaining their households. Developing a budget; an organizational system; and a schedule for cleaning, shopping, errands, and other day-to-day necessities is necessary whether they are in a relationship or not. Luckily for Architects,

who are driven by the Judging trait, they're excellent strategists and creatures of routine. With a little effort, the right focus, and planning, adding regular budgeting sessions – and vacuuming the living room – to their shared routine are well within their reach.

Here are some actionable steps Architects and Analysts can take:

- Decide roles. In every household, partners have their own expertise and do things more efficiently and competently than their counterparts. They can share some tasks, and partners can take turns with others. But assuming one partner will take care of things without both partners agreeing can be filled with pitfalls and conflict.
- Post household chores and an errand chart on the refrigerator or other prominent, shared space.
- Select a budget app or program that best serves both types. Have a weekly, scheduled "date" over a glass of wine or a nice dessert, and assess the budget by reviewing the past month and projecting financial plans to cover the near and distant future.
- Set goals for practical tasks and celebrate meeting those goals. For example, if couples mark on a calendar that they've taken out the trash every night for 30 days, they can enjoy an evening that includes a dinner, a movie, or a stop at a jazz bar on the way home.

Concrete measures are essential for completing concrete tasks. For Architect-Analyst couples, codifying their household chores and responsibilities as concretely as possible can help them avoid the trap of dwelling too long on intangibles and future intentions.

Architect-Diplomat Relationships

Diplomats' core traits are Intuitive and Feeling. Thanks to the Intuitive part of that combination, Diplomats and Architects share a visionary, open-minded view of the world. Unlike most other types, they live in a world of ideas and abstractions. The only Architect trait not shared by any Diplomats is the Thinking trait; whereas Architects value decisions and motivations that spring from rationality, Diplomats typically prize decisions that come from emotions. When Architects and Diplomats fall in love, there's a good chance that both the gifts they bring to each other and the potential conflicts in their relationships will come from that difference.

Balanced Architect-Diplomat Relationships

Open-Minded Visionaries

On a first date, rather than fireworks, passion, and love at first sight, concepts and theories may more readily connect Architects and their potential Diplomat partners. Neither of these personality types values small talk, so that's likely off the table right away. Although Architects focus more on systems and rationality and Diplomats on humanity and values, they both love talking about big ideas. Even with their different emphases, Architects and Diplomats each plant creative concepts and dreams in the other's mental landscapes. Chances are good they'll never run out of conversation material.

Passion can simmer in this pairing, although Diplomats are likely to be much more expressive than Architects – especially Protagonists and Campaigners, with their outgoing natures. Because dating is an exploratory activity, Diplomats are likely to lead the way in the discovery process. But Architects aren't passive participants – they

quietly observe the process and find their own unique footing in new love affairs. This pattern is likely to follow them as romances progress to new levels and as love deepens.

Altruism and Rational Self-Interest

Being both an Introverted and Thinking type, Architects find themselves focused largely on their inner worlds. They're among the types least likely to say they're willing to sacrifice their own needs for others, whereas Diplomats are among the most likely. Architects do possess compassion and are capable of self-sacrifice, but Diplomats' enthusiasm for helping others and their profound sense of empathy can inspire Architects to take a deeper, more generous look at the people around them.

On the other hand, Architects can help Diplomats pay more attention to their self-interest amid their idealism. Their empathy and desire to "do good" at all costs can quickly drain Diplomats, and their Architect partners can help them to recognize and address the issue. Balancing altruism and self-interest is tricky but necessary for the health of these individuals *and* their relationships. The gentle pull of these partners toward a happy medium helps both find the sweet spot in compromise.

Unbalanced Architect-Diplomat Relationships

Showing Affection

The Architect-Diplomat combination may seem powerfully complementary, but there are hurdles to cross when either type is excessive in the expression of their personal characteristics. These couples often face obstacles due to differing points of view on romantic gestures and emotional expressions. Diplomats consider such gestures symbolic, a metaphor for something greater. Architects may roll their eyes at the thought of buying a bouquet and having it sit in a vase, only to wither away in a matter of days. Meanwhile, the flowers, no matter how ephemeral, touch Diplomats as a symbol of love and appreciation.

Architects can read cues from Diplomats and learn the behaviors expected in their relationships. They may engage in some of the

rituals of courtship begrudgingly or through conditioning. They'll buy or receive the flowers in an expected fashion. But none of this means the same thing to them as it does to their Diplomat sweethearts. This has its dangers: Diplomats can't abide someone they feel is phony, and if they sense that their Architect partners' gestures of affection aren't heartfelt, they're likely to feel disappointment. Diplomats are uncanny in their ability to separate the genuine from the insincere. They may tolerate Architects going through the motions once their relationships mature and they understand each other. In the initial stages of a romantic relationship, however, when they are trying to gauge each other's interest, this inconsistency can stop a relationship before it starts.

Solutions-Based Support

Diplomats may too often commiserate or otherwise show empathy to Architects, who are looking for rational solutions and not "touchy-feely" sentiments. To Architects, this appears to be frivolous emoting with a lack of real substance. What sounds like a warm offering of emotional support to Diplomats seems to be a useless irritant to Architects, who at times can dismiss ways other than their own. Instead of experiencing the intended support, they find themselves annoyed.

A cycle begins when Diplomats feel dejected because their Architect lovers don't seem to understand what they're going through, whereas Architects remain frustrated by a foreign injection of emotions into their problems. Diplomats' overall sensitivity and concern for others' feelings can seem excessive or irrational to Architect partners. Issues arise when Diplomat lovers want to vent about problems. Architects jump to offer solutions – not sympathy or compassion. When Diplomats bring issues to their Architect partners, they're likely not looking for a battery of action plans. They simply want someone to listen to them and let them know they understand their pain. Diplomats may misinterpret Architects' sincere expression of assistance as lacking sympathy, and perhaps even as careless. To emotionally centered Diplomats, it may seem like Architect partners just want to dispatch their problems without regard for their feelings. It's not that Architects don't care, it's just that, to them, it makes more sense to fix problems than to dwell on their emotional implications.

Rebalancing Architect-Diplomat Relationships

Understanding and Appreciating Differences

Actively working to understand each other and appreciate their differences can smooth over Architect-Diplomat couples' potential conflicts. Thanks to their shared Intuitive trait, these individuals can be open-minded enough to place value on their beloveds' personality styles. Although Architects can be stubborn, they're not irrationally so. When they partner with thoughtful, loving Diplomats, they learn to appreciate the positives in their partners' ways.

The differences between Architects and Diplomats regarding romantic gestures may at least partially resolve themselves in time. Insightful Diplomats grow to understand that Architects' affections run deep, even if they don't ever fully master outward expressions of love. In turn, Architects come to appreciate how important such gestures can be to their Diplomat partners, and they can show it in different ways:

- Learn about romantic signals and traditional conventions, like Valentine's Day and anniversaries, and respond to them. It only takes a little research to find out what these gestures are.
- Set an affectionate gesture quota for yourself. For example, decide to hug your partner at least twice a day and make a deliberate effort to ensure that contact. In a similar vein, decide to say, "I love you," to your partner three times every day.
- Consider a structured approach to symbolic gestures, such as keeping and selecting from a list of loving gestures. For example, a kiss when leaving in the morning sets the mood for the day and reassures a partner before a period of absence. Spontaneity isn't the only romantic value; sometimes dependable affection is extremely attractive.

Diplomats are likely to appreciate the love behind any efforts Architects make. Despite their standards for authenticity, they realize that, although Architects may not always connect deeply with their own expressions of love, they're sincere in their desire to please. And, for Architects, it's likely worth the effort.

Sympathy Over Answers

Architects give comfort by providing solutions rather than sympathy, but it comes from a loving place. However, connecting with their lovers' needs is also important, and definitive answers aren't always what they crave.

Intentional listening is the most valuable tool in the sympathy toolbox, as well as one of the most useful skills to develop. When their Diplomat partners vent about frustrating situations, Architects should first listen to get all the information. Then, instead of trying to solve problems, they should simply repeat the information they've heard. For example, they can say, "So, it sounds like you were really upset when your coworkers didn't invite you out for drinks after work." Emphasizing that they truly heard what their Diplomat sweethearts said is often much more important than judging what they're saying or trying to fix the problem. Adding an empathic statement, such as, "I am so sorry that they didn't invite you," is more comforting (and does more to calm the situation) than suggesting a revengeful solution like, "You should just ignore them the next time they ask you for help." Sympathy provides its own solutions to problems, and they're often more effective than forced fixes.

When their Diplomat partners come to them with complaints or problems, Architects may want to start by asking questions and reflecting understanding in a caring manner. Here are some ideas and suggestions Architects can keep in mind for practicing sympathy effectively:

- Listening actively is an essential tool in the world of Diplomats. A more receptive stance outshines any misplaced attempts at offering solutions, at least as a first step. It indicates that you are more eager about receiving information than providing it – leaving Diplomats with the feeling that they've been heard.
- Body language is essential. Architects can get lost in thought, searching for the right solution, and forget the basics of physical connection during communication. Leaning forward, making loving eye contact, and nodding at the right times all encourage partners to share.

- Assure your partner that you've heard them by paraphrasing what you've heard, but be careful not to be too interpretative. Come as close to what your Diplomat partner said as you can, only using different words, and then ask, "Is that what you're saying?" Return to active listening and modify your questions until you fully understand what your partner is feeling and thinking.
- At some point, once your Diplomat partner has an opportunity to speak about their feelings, it may be appropriate to ask if they want suggestions. However, actively resist offering any until you receive the go-ahead.

Everyone likes to be heard, and there's no wrong way to respond. However, it may be important for Architects when connecting with others to try to "speak their language." Knowing what others want and need, and providing those things when appropriate, is an important part of building relationships. Not all problems need an immediate solution.

Architect-Sentinel Relationships

Sentinels, with their Observant trait, aren't nearly as enamored with ideas and visions as their Architect partners might be. Such abstract considerations seem impractical to them. They prefer to pay attention to the present moment and the world around them. However, the potential for complementary relationships between the two is immense.

Balanced Architect-Sentinel Relationships

Knowing What They Want

Sentinels make up their minds about how they wish their lives to be –

and if things change, they often cling to the way things were in the past. Both Architects and Sentinels respect order and predictability, albeit in different ways. Architects are interested in more abstract systems as expressions of order, whereas Sentinels find that organizing the tangible is more to their liking.

Dating provides an excellent example of how their approaches differ. Once Architects decide to find a romantic partner, they view dating as a pressing task – difficult but necessary. They consider what they want in a systematic fashion, then use a logical system to develop a list of qualities they expect in potential partners. Sentinels also rely on fixed qualities when seeking partners. However, their requirements are unlikely to be determined by a checklist they've developed from pure logic. They rely on experience, gleaning the characteristics they're seeking from traditions they've known, concrete life lessons they've learned, and societal expectations.

Because of their personality traits, both partners in these pairings find a solid foundation in each other. Although some types prefer a serendipitous approach to love – eyes meeting across the room and that sort of thing – such relations can feel flimsy. In contrast, Architects and Sentinels who fall in love are likely to have the sense that their romance is very deliberate. Their checklists ensure all the essential elements are in place in their relationships, fostering a sense of confidence.

Serious and Stable

Reliability holds great appeal for Sentinels, and Architects impress them with their serious nature, intelligent demeanor, and intense work ethic. These traits align with Sentinels' desire for stable lives with good spouses. Sentinels' organizational abilities, their rigorous attention to daily matters, and their regard for social conventions and family can help Architects compensate for what they lack in those areas. Architects solve problems in the lofty reaches of conceptual thought, whereas Sentinels anchor their lives by attending to everyday concerns.

Architect-Sentinel romantic partnerships can be influenced by whether Sentinel partners have the Thinking trait or the Feeling trait. Those with the Thinking trait can be more at home with Architects'

analytical nature. Feeling Sentinels want more emotional support and communication than their Thinking counterparts. Although Feeling Sentinels are distinct from Diplomats, they share some similarities in their relationships with Architects. However, unlike Diplomats, they're likely to respond to their emotions in more concrete ways, and they often welcome their Architect partners' compulsion to offer practical fixes to their problems.

Unbalanced Architect-Sentinel Relationships

Lacking in Recognition and Sensitivity

Architects sometimes project condescension when they see their rational approach as superior. Such perceived contempt is especially hurtful for Sentinels, who put significant effort into creating stable homes and relationships. The everyday accomplishments that Sentinels handle deftly, and with some pride, can easily fly below the radar of their Architect lovers. Sentinels rarely ask for praise, but they still enjoy it. When appreciation isn't forthcoming, they may become passive-aggressive. Sentinels and Architects prize loyalty, so this disconnect may not derail their love affairs entirely, but this lack of recognition creates significant pain for Sentinels, who sometimes respond by indirectly expressing anger rather than upsetting their traditional and well-organized apple carts. It may not be *entirely* an accident the next day when Architects find their toast is burnt.

When Intuitive and Observant types meet, clashing over practical matters can be a regular point of contention. Due to their sometimes-exclusive attention to precise matters, Architects can miss things; compared to Sentinels' concrete pragmatism, they often appear absent-minded. When it comes to Architects, this contrast is less prominent, however, due to the orderly influences of their Judging trait. In fact, a well-ordered environment may even have a calming effect on Architects, and they often find comfort in partners with organizational talents.

Nonetheless, unless it's of interest to Architects, they might tolerate dirty dishes in the sink a little longer than Sentinels, especially if they have something else on their minds. It's not overt neglect: domestic

order might be on their radar, but it isn't as high on their list of priorities as it is for Sentinels. Yet, because such everyday matters are so essential to the stability Sentinels value, they easily become ongoing conflicts in otherwise loving relationships.

Open-Minded Versus Traditional

Architects are always looking to deconstruct ideas and reassemble them into improved states. Sentinels, however, prefer the familiar, and they accept change reluctantly. Architects can harm their relationships if they treat their lovers as systems to tweak. Sentinels, even those with the Thinking trait, aren't likely to understand or fully appreciate this mindset. They may even view Architects' penchant for improvement as a threat to the stability they worked so hard to build. Furthermore, if they interpret such an endeavor as a criticism of their efforts, Sentinels easily become hurt and defensive. Architects' rebuilding of the world into an enhanced place may appear to be nothing less than destructive to their Sentinel partners.

Finally, Architects sometimes enjoy considering ideas that might seem controversial to the more mainstream Sentinels. If Sentinels take their Architect partners too seriously, they might become alarmed or even offended. An assault on conventional thinking, even if it's solely in the realm of the theoretical, jolts tradition-loving Sentinels. In response, Architects can see Sentinels as unrefined thinkers, and that attitude can come across to Sentinels as condescension. Without mutual respect, different approaches to new ideas can cause rifts in Architect-Sentinel relationships.

Rebalancing Architect-Sentinel Relationships

Avoiding Personality Makeovers

A common mistake among romantic partners is to see their own traits as superior. Architects and Sentinels are distinct personality types, and both can be insistent that their way is better. But attempting to remake a significant other into one's own image is rarely successful. Architects need to appreciate that Sentinels aren't always comfortable with their big ideas and constant attempts to improve things. Without this awareness, trying to force them to "get it" can become a futile obsession.

Likewise, Sentinels may never quite domesticate their Architect partners as fully as they would like. In fact, Architects are among the types least likely to be persuaded by others, and they are most liable to see compromise as a form of failure. Family traditions may never capture Architects' hearts, and they can often be distracted from the conventional aspects of life that are so important to Sentinels. Here are some ways they can stay "in the moment" with their sweethearts:

- Avoid partner "makeovers." It's a fool's errand to commit to another with the intention of changing them. An appropriate balance would involve each member *voluntarily* dedicating themselves to their own growth, and an openness to learning from each other.
- Invest time in finding out what each person values. Avoid assuming you know what your Sentinel lover holds dear. There may be more depth and substance there than what you suspect.
- Avoid overanalyzing motives. Sometimes the most obvious reason for something is the only relevant reason. Someone who insists on a meticulous house may not be a control freak, just someone who likes a clean house.
- Remember the original reasons you fell in love – those characteristics probably haven't changed. More likely, the disconnect between partners is about shifting expectations.

It's helpful to remember that relationships are often complementary, even between similar types. Thinking of significant others as gifts that enhance, rather than obstacles to overcome, goes a long way in relationships, especially when partners have diverse characteristics.

Ideas and Gratitude

Architect and Sentinel romantic partners each have a unique focus – Architects on ideas and Sentinels on getting things done. Finding ways to relate to each other's focus is essential to healthy relationships. For Sentinels, this involves taking things in stride; for Architects, it's showing appreciation for the stability a Sentinel lover brings.

Sentinels benefit from knowing that when Architects explore ideas, they aren't always serious about their application in life. Architects'

wilder theories and concepts are often just that: theories and concepts. It's a game they play with themselves to exercise their imaginations, and there's no need for alarm. Aware Architects can point out that, when they share these thoughts, they're just "playing with ideas."

To enhance their connections, Architects can make a special point to express gratitude to the Sentinels they love. It's easy to discover the many ways Sentinels contribute to their relationships, and this goes beyond simple utilitarian things like organizing their households. Sentinels truly want to safeguard the people they love, so they do what they can to meet as many of their needs as possible. Architects return their loyalty, but in far less tangible ways. Although they can be independent and don't need to hear expressions of gratitude as much as other types, they shouldn't assume the same applies to their Sentinel sweethearts. Praise can be the most cherished gift Architects can give them. It's reassuring for Sentinels when their partners endorse and value the stability they create.

Architects can cement their relationships with the Sentinels they love by doing some of the following:

- Make it a point to separate and label theory from actual plans and realities.
- If it's not a practical consideration, Sentinels may not know exactly what to do with the information. Point out that no action is required in response to your theoretical musings; it may allow Sentinels to relax and keep things in context.
- Reassure each other by showing gratitude. Gratitude is more than a nicety. It's an opportunity to confirm love for others by expressing appreciation. It doesn't even have to be grounded in a specific instance or favor – in fact, sometimes the best gratitude says, in some form, "Thanks for being you."

Providing a cushion by clarifying the nature of their ideas can help Architects ease their Sentinel partners into their world. Likewise, each can bring more confidence and reassurance into their romances by making special efforts to show gratitude.

Architect-Explorer Relationships

Like the Architect-Sentinel pairings described above, Architect-Explorer couples are Intuitive-Observant pairs with the typical divide between visionaries and hands-on "doers." Explorers live entirely in the present and seek out the new and the exciting. They're curious about almost everything, excluding long-winded discussions involving abstractions and ideas – which are among Architects' favorite things. Yet despite their differences, Architects and Explorers in love bring generous gifts to each other's worlds.

Balanced Architect-Explorer Relationships

Imagining and Doing

Explorers love specific challenges, like mastering a musical instrument or a craft. Both enjoy solving things, but Architects ponder theoretical puzzles, whereas Explorers think on their feet, unraveling real and immediate problems. This difference, although pronounced, can be complementary if they seek common ground.

If Architects can connect ideas they love to something practical and immediately useful, they can impress their Explorer partners. For example, those who know about computer code might appeal to Explorers' appreciation of tools and devices by talking about what code accomplishes. However, if Architects' discussions veer off into the hypothetical social implications of artificial intelligence, they risk boring Explorers, who aren't likely to see the relevance. Immediate, tangible topics are more likely to engage their Explorer lovers.

For these couples, it can be quite exciting when Architects come up with ideas or present new information and Explorers respond by running

with them. Having their visions realized is likely to shake Architects out of their cerebral worlds enough to insert some practicality into their lives. This can result in dynamic relationships filled with ideas and accomplishments.

Open-Mindedness Meets Spontaneity

Explorers' spontaneity and practicality attract Architects, to a degree: they aren't always as comfortable in new situations as Explorers are, especially Entrepreneurs and Entertainers, whose outgoing natures are the stuff of legends. As a counterbalance to their own more serious natures, they enjoy Explorers' loose, fun-loving attitude, but only within some "reasonable" boundaries. If individual Explorers are excessively spontaneous or capricious, Architects can see them as frivolous, perhaps even threatening to the more serious, ordered lives they prefer.

In committed relationships, Architects and Explorers appreciate each other's disregard for social convention. Both tend to be less attached to concerns about how the world "should" be than their Diplomat and Sentinel cousins. Architects and Explorers welcome the space and freedom they grant each other. For example, when Architects become so obsessed with projects they seem almost entirely detached from their home lives, it works out well for independent Explorers, giving them ample time to discover their world in their distinct way. Nobody ever accuses Architect-Explorer couples of smothering each other.

Unbalanced Architect-Explorer Relationships

Occasionally Condescending and Impatient

Independent Explorers aren't necessarily sensitive to criticism, but they're not immune to it, either. Architects can come across as condescending: they put such value on their rational focus that their Explorer partners might feel that their own, more practical contributions are comparatively banal and uninteresting. This may occur unintentionally, or even intentionally when it comes to immature or insecure Architects. Lovers who consistently project a sense of superiority and condescension over each other can erode the affection that holds them together. Architects must exercise diligence

regarding their partners' feelings, especially with emotions-oriented Adventurers and Entertainers.

With their respect for longevity, Architects may want to take care: Explorers are as capable as anyone when it comes to commitment, but they're also independent and fearless of change. Independent people generally leave much quicker than others if they aren't happy. As in all relationships, loving respect is one of the keys to longevity.

Explorers, on the other hand, can become impatient with Architects' insatiable love of knowledge and theories. They tend to grow bored with theory, and although Architects also seem immune to criticism, the truth is they often feel deeply and are hurt more easily than they let on. Explorers should take care not to dismiss their sweethearts as stodgy, intellectually elitist, or boring. This sort of "reverse snobbery" can be just as hurtful as snobbery itself.

Different Rhythms

Architects and Explorers have several characteristics in common – their love of solving real-life riddles, for example. But they differ in how they focus their attention on those puzzles. When Architects face a problem, they prefer to spend a lengthy amount of time methodically deconstructing it and then rebuilding it, looking for as many viable solutions as possible. Explorers are as persistent as the adrenaline charge they get from working on a specific challenge. Once it becomes too repetitive and feels routine, once the excitement starts to evaporate a little, they're looking for the next fascination. Novelty draws Explorers in. Architects who understand the life-rhythms of their Explorer partners are a step closer to accepting them.

Architects' slow, meticulous deliberation may annoy their Explorer lovers, whereas Architects may regard Explorers as too flighty and lacking any substance. This puts them on differing trajectories for decision-making, and the features they loved so much in each other in the beginning may become a tiresome load. Architects may wonder why Explorers can't dedicate themselves to matters that seem important to them, and Explorers may see Architects as slow-to-change anchors that stall their pursuit of the fresh and unique.

Rebalancing Architect-Explorer Relationships

Resisting the Urge to Judge

As always, understanding is the initial step to resolving problems in all relationships; personality theory and honest conversation can be useful tools. Explorers may not be quite so eager to get into the weeds of personality theory. However, those who learn about their partners' traits can feed into Architects' love for the theoretical, systemic, and formulaic. Keeping the discussion centered on current, observable behaviors rather than abstract concepts may bring the differences to life for them.

Both approaches to life can be equally legitimate. In fact, if they lend their strengths to each other, their differences can provide profound opportunities for growth. Architects who overthink things might learn how to turn ideas into accomplishments, thanks to their action-oriented Explorer partners. In return, Architects can provide needed planning and preparation for life's more complex considerations, and they can moderate Explorers' sometimes impulsive tendencies.

Slowing down and thoroughly analyzing situations aren't as bad as some Explorers might imagine. Add a deliberate regard for each other's feelings and an appreciation for each other's strengths, and the glue of loving respect can set. It doesn't hurt to learn to accept romantic partners' weaknesses with kindness, love, and good humor, either. Architects do well to say "yes" much more than they say "no" to the Explorers they love. To do so, they can try this "trust and let go" exercise:

- Agree to a stretch of time when you will commit to trusting your Explorer partner's instincts.
- Discuss with your partner:
  - What would be a safe or unsafe boundary of trust?
  - What constitutes a genuine or ingenuine request?
- During that time, commit to saying "yes" to the next five genuine, safe requests your Explorer partner makes.
- Always debrief by exchanging thoughts on the exercise after it's realized.
  - If either person believes a request crossed a boundary or did not represent a "genuine" request, talk about it.

Sometimes it takes a shift in attitude for the appropriate actions to emerge. For Architects and Explorers, such attitude shifts may rely largely on avoiding being judgmental and looking for qualities to appreciate in each other.

Adopting Alternative Rhythms

No matter the personality type, adaptation is crucial in life. This doesn't mean people shouldn't be true to themselves and play to their strengths. For Architect and Explorer couples, adaptation often involves accepting the different foci and preferences of their loved ones. It doesn't necessarily mean keeping pace with each other – although Architects sharing their deliberative natures and Explorers sharing their spontaneous styles can be beneficial. It more often means tolerating, even appreciating, their differences.

Architects wanting to understand the style of Explorers who have stolen their hearts might try joining in on their adventures occasionally. This offers many advantages, with the most relevant to romance involving understanding and connecting more intimately with their Explorer partners. Henry Miller wrote, "All growth is a leap in the dark, a spontaneous, unpremeditated act without the benefit of experience." Whether it is or not, sometimes Architects must allow life to unfold more on its own and in a less controlled fashion if they're to experience it more fully. Sharing in their Explorer lovers' hunger for the fresh and novel can stimulate that appetite in themselves.

A role-reversal exercise that has Architects initiate what Explorers might normally suggest can pump more enthusiasm into relationships stuck on their differences:

- Look for an event your Explorer partner might like. Finding out what that is might take some time and objective observation. When choosing, keep the focus on your Explorer partner's preferences.
- Set up a "surprise" date based on that event.
- Keep an open mind and a willing attitude. Those can make almost anything pleasant, maybe even enjoyable.

Architects, perhaps a little more than most, cling tightly to their own preferences and styles. When Architect-Explorer couples exchange some of those things, each is treated to a bigger world. But even more important for this discussion, sharing can pull lovers with such different approaches to life closer together.

Conclusion

Better Than a Sonnet

When Architects are in love, it isn't likely to be the stuff of poets and sonnets. Compared with what we see in popular media, their love lives might appear sedate – and this proves the adage that looks can be deceiving. Not all romances come with grand gestures and shows of emotion, and Architects form close bonds in other ways. All relationships take work and attention. With occasional adjustments to their focus and priorities, Architects can offer their most sincere love and devotion.

Being comfortable with what love means for their personality type is likely the first and biggest hurdle that Architects face, as they show love differently than other types. But once they've made that leap, their confidence gets stronger: they don't need to look like anyone else or follow the scripts of conventional love stories to have wonderful romances custom-made for them and their lovers. It's the rarest version of any collectible that's the most valuable – an idea worth clinging to when Architects pursue romance.

Naturally Improving

Future-focused Architects have a strong inclination toward improvement. When they keep in mind that romances are about human needs and desires, this quality can hold power in their relationships. Love involves accepting and cherishing each other's gifts as much as it does growth, and they can keep in mind that this is a virtuous impulse. Contentment and emotional fulfillment can coexist with Architects' preference for rationality and systemic improvement, but only if they strive to create a marriage between their cerebral preferences and matters of the heart.

This chapter has offered insights and suggestions for romance – a topic that isn't always comfortable for Architects. Hopefully, it can help them get the most out of relationships and strengthen the components of a good life. Being in love is one of the most exciting and intimidating of all human experiences. Love brings both hope and risk, fulfillment and yearning, and it carries potential for a wide range of new experiences and understanding.

Love is about more than the right skills and the right words – it's about extending one's self to merge with another while still maintaining a unique identity. That's a lot of work, and it takes courage to do it right. Architects have what it takes to meet the challenges that love brings and to develop beautiful relationships born of their unique style.

Friendships

In friendships, as in other areas of their lives, Architects seek quality, not quantity. For people with this personality type, life is too short for small talk. They want to spend time with a few friends whom they respect – in other words, friends who can sustain deep, meaningful conversations. Although expressing affection can be a challenge for them, Architects can be incredibly loyal nonetheless, showing they care by lending a hand whenever needed.

Architects as Friends

People with the Architect personality type value self-sufficiency and independence, but they also value friendship. They get by with relatively little day-to-day attention even from their close friends, and they expect to stay on good terms with them without much maintenance. For Architects, confidence in a friendship replaces a need for constant reaffirmation, and they draw great comfort from knowing that their true friends are available if needed.

When they're among such friends, they relax and enjoy themselves, especially in small gatherings. For those who can keep up, Architects offer fantastic storytelling, conversation, and spirited debate. They can be painfully honest, but their capacity for discourse is sublime, and they love to display their wit. Their sarcasm and dark humor may not be for the faint of heart, nor for those who struggle to read between the lines. However, when circumstances are right, Architects enjoy coming out of their shell for a dose of irreverent fun and companionship.

True Belonging

For Architects, friendships aren't just about stimulating conversations and high-flying discussions – although those are welcome benefits. Interpersonal connection benefits these individuals on a deep level, where they may crave emotional as well as intellectual acceptance, even if they don't realize it. Although they enjoy and even thrive on freedom and solitude, they can easily suffer from disconnection and loneliness. As a result, people with this personality type are healthiest when they occasionally drop their defenses to enjoy the warmth and sense of belonging that friendship offers.

It's not always easy for close friendships to grow around Architects, who may come across as intimidating, especially given their disregard for traditional rules of social conduct. For their part, Architects may be tempted to dismiss anyone who falls short of their exacting standards. Even friends who make the cut may be conscious of being judged by them, which is hardly a recipe for easy connection. Fortunately, if Architects learn to temper their judgments and brush up on their emotional intelligence, they can enjoy meaningful friendships that can stand the test of time and help them feel at home in the world.

Friends Aren't Mechanical

Logic may be king in many systems, but friendships – like most relationships – are subject to emotional whims. This can be uncomfortable for Architects, who tend to be wary or even resentful of unpredictable emotional behavior. When social opportunities arise, their preference for rational stability over emotional openness can hold them back, making them seem aloof and cold. This distance extends in both directions, making Architects difficult to get to know and making it hard for them to understand their friends' feelings.

They can also be out of their element when it comes to giving or asking for emotional support. When emotionally charged situations occur, Architects often have no clue how to handle them appropriately – a stark contrast to their usual competence. This seeming emotional abandonment can make them seem uncaring, even when they truly mean to help. Architects often forego sympathy, preferring instead to offer logical solutions, which they see as the best way to support

their friends. However well-intended, such advice, suggestions, and feedback rarely comfort those craving an emotional salve.

Making Friends

Although Architects can be loyal, appreciative friends, they may have difficulty establishing connections in the first place. Given the combination of their Introversion with the Judging trait, they can fall into patterns of self-isolation and therefore have difficulty meeting new people. And given their high standards, they might struggle to find others who seem compatible or worthwhile among the people they do meet.

For Architects who want to make new friends, two options might suit their tendencies. The first is to look more closely at the people they already encounter on a regular basis, such as classmates, coworkers, and neighbors. To get to know such individuals better, they can practice elevating small talk into more substantial discussions. For example, if "What did you do this weekend?" reveals that a neighbor went to a concert, Architects can steer the conversation toward the merits of different styles of music. This strategy can not only help them break out of small-talk prison but also reveal people who can carry the types of discussions they enjoy. The trick is to balance listening and talking, with Architects offering enough of their perspective to keep the conversation afloat but also listening and responding to what the other person says.

The second option that's often amenable to Architects in search of friendship is to frequent new places. They might enjoy participating in a reading group, taking a class, joining a new exercise program, or even hanging out in a coffee shop or bookstore they haven't frequented before. The important principle is to show up regularly. Encountering the same people week after week builds familiarity, which may make Architects more comfortable joining or starting conversations. At some point, they can take another step by asking a new acquaintance to grab a coffee together, go out for a drink, or meet up at an event. Although this might initially feel like a strain, Architects don't balk at a challenge – and in the end, many people they'll meet will be delighted to make new friends.

Beyond the Usual

Architects want to surround themselves with authentic, intellectually curious people who have strong values and interests. With such high standards, many people of this personality type rely on befriending people who enjoy the same things they do, so they may find their friends at work, in the classroom, or through organized clubs or activities.

When searching for friends, it's perfectly natural to look for common ground, but this preference can be restrictive. A world of people exists beyond their workplace or their favorite activities. By opening their minds and considering people with divergent interests and personalities, Architects can move beyond obvious compatibility and establish significant friendships with individuals who are different from them.

Engaging with people of differing mindsets can be a powerfully beneficial learning opportunity for Architects. When meeting people with diverse experiences, opinions, and backgrounds, they can ask themselves, "What can I learn from this person? How might this friendship benefit me?" If there's one thing they appreciate, it's weighing different possibilities to craft an ideal approach. Architects can't help but be intrigued by anyone who sheds new light on their assumptions and advances their thinking – a great start to a friendship.

Architect Friendships by Role

Architects tend to have consistent natures, but their highly analytical minds help them see the advantages of relating to different people in different ways, as everyone can offer something unique. Although any willing people might become friends, some helpful or hindering aspects of their personality types come to the forefront in friendships. Let's examine the tendencies that are most likely to affect Architects in friendships with all four Role groups.

Architect-Analyst Friendships

At times, Architects can feel at odds with the world. Everywhere they turn, they tend to see others making irrational decisions, settling for the status quo, and being fake to be likable or impressive. Fortunately, Analyst friends can help them feel less alone in their values of rationality, progress, and authenticity. When they befriend other Analysts, Architects often feel energized yet comfortable, delighting in the company of those who understand and accept them.

Balanced Architect-Analyst Friendships

An Easy Match

Other Analysts make fitting friends for Architects, as they share a passion for new ideas, discovery, and unconventional thought. Such friendships tend to revolve more around intellectual engagement than social or emotional support, which Architects often prefer. They are rare, so they may be accustomed to feeling incompatible and misunderstood; friendship with other Analysts can be a comforting and invigorating breath of fresh air.

That fresh air comes in handy, because these friends never run out of things to talk about. Architects' minds constantly buzz with analyses, questions, and ideas, and other Analysts are delighted to keep pace. These friends love bouncing ideas back and forth, and their shared analytical prowess enables them to dissect each other's ideas – a process they find enjoyable, however odd that may strike other types. There may also be some pleasant competition, with each type challenging the other to establish a stronger foundation for their thoughts.

Free to Be

Even independent-minded Architects can feel pressure to conform. Every day, advertisements and social media carpet-bomb audiences with carefully curated images of what it means to be successful, happy, or desirable. Spending time with Analyst friends – who share a healthy disrespect for societal expectations – reassures Architects that they're free to be themselves.

Other Analyst types may challenge Architects with hard-hitting questions, but at their core, they deeply respect and appreciate their friends for who they are. As a result, time spent with Analysts can help Architects feel empowered to be authentic and pursue their interests and curiosity with little or no inhibition, whether they're fascinated by sound engineering, avian migration, or New York history. In turn, Architects who unabashedly pursue their interests, embrace their quirks, and prioritize their values can inspire their Analyst friends to do the same.

Unbalanced Architect-Analyst Friendships

Fix It Now

Architects have little tolerance for ineffectiveness, procrastination, or indecision, and their tendency to see broken systems everywhere creates a strong pull to fix things. As a result, they can lose patience with friends who put off decisive actions. If pals complain about their jobs without applying for new ones, for example, ever-candid Architects won't hesitate to call out their inconsistency.

This confrontational tendency can spark tension with other Analyst types – particularly Debaters and Logicians – who might discuss ideas or solutions without readily acting on them. Architects may be trying to inspire their friends to finally *do* something by pointing out their inaction, but the approach can backfire if they come on too strong. At first, their friends may feel defensive, annoyed, or even stifled. Over time, they might pull away from Architects altogether, not wanting to deal with their judgment or their impatience.

Say What?

When emotionally charged situations arise – whether issues within their friendships or personal life challenges – Architects generally don't crave profuse apologies, pity, or hugs. In many situations, they may appreciate matter-of-fact Analyst friends who help them figure things out rationally and identify action steps. At times, however, even Architects want their friends to validate their experiences, express empathy, or try to cheer them up.

Alas, other Analysts may be unable to offer emotional support, just as Architects struggle to listen and empathize when their friends go through their own hard times. Architects and other Analyst types are certainly capable of this type of support, but it is a skill they must actively develop. In general, their default is to offer advice rather than compassion. However, this robs all Analyst types of the emotional healing and deep bonding that result from carrying each other through difficult times.

Rebalancing Architect-Analyst Friendships

Inspire, Don't Push

Here's a rational argument against pushing friends to act: it rarely works. No one wants to feel criticized or nagged, and even other rational-minded Analysts may dig in their heels when Architects point out how they're failing to live out their ideas. This often befuddles Architects, whose "pestering" is generally motivated by deep thoughtfulness and a sincere desire to help.

So how can they manage friendships with people who aren't as decisive as they are? The first step is to observe and note their current behavior. Architects may be surprised to realize how often they bring up their friends' areas of inaction, such as looking for a new job or finally starting an exercise regimen. The second step is to remember that nobody puts off action without a reason. Either they are encountering resistance – perhaps due to insecurity, uncertainty, or other obligations – or they're less interested in making changes than they thought. Neither circumstance is inherently wrong, and even most Architects have experienced them at one point or another.

The third step is to recognize that, if someone is truly struggling to act, showing support works better than badgering or shaming them.

To support their friends who are putting off an important change, Architects can try the following exercise:

- It's often easier to spot inconsistencies in another person's behavior. Before commenting on a friend's choices (or lack thereof), pause to consider whether you're projecting any of your own issues. For example, could it be that you're fixating on a friend's job dissatisfaction rather than facing up to your own?
- Ask questions before offering advice, and listen carefully: "What do you think is holding you back? What would be a realistic first step for you to take?"
- Architects want to help in concrete ways, and this is a gift – provided their friends are ready for it. Make a specific offer to help *only after listening to the answers in the previous step*, and ensure that your offer aligns with your friend's vision for next steps. In other words, if they think a realistic first step is to update their resume, don't offer to get them an interview with the CEO of a company.
- Don't impose a deadline on the offer of assistance. Saying, "I'm here to help when you're ready," can go a long way.
- When in doubt, Architects can inspire their friends simply by making needed changes in their *own* lives – whether asking for a promotion, learning a new skill, or signing up for a 5K run. This way, friends know where to turn when they need guidance and support in taking charge.

Architects might want to serve their friends hard-nosed "reality checks," but even with other Analysts, the approach usually backfires. By supporting rather than pushing friends who aren't taking initiative, Architects can honor their own desire to help without diminishing their friends' self-esteem or unduly straining their relationships.

Emotion in Motion

Far from being pointless or unhelpful, emotional conversations serve an important purpose in relationships. Such conversations clear

the air, make everyone feel seen and heard, and ultimately bring companions closer. At times, even Architects and their Analyst friends crave the release and comfort offered by conversations about feelings – rather than facts, strategies, or advice.

Architects and other Analysts may feel ill-equipped for such moments, fearing that they'll get mired in cyclical, never-ending, irrational discussions. Or perhaps they worry that they'll lose control, alienate their friends, or generally embarrass themselves. As a result, they may try to suppress their emotions, rather than feeling or expressing them. However, as Carl Jung said, "What you resist not only persists, but will grow in size." In other words, the surest way to get stuck in an emotion is to try to suppress it.

Therefore, the first step in offering emotional support is to learn how to feel. This comes naturally to some people, but not to others, including Architects. They get lost in thoughts *about* their feelings, or their efforts to distract themselves from feelings, at the expense of processing those feelings and moving on.

To feel in an undistracted way, Architects can try the following exercise the next time they're on their own and feeling uneasy in a way that might be emotional.

- Set a timer for three minutes. Commit to doing nothing else during this time.
- Notice bodily sensations. Is your jaw clenched? Are your shoulders hunched? What is your sitting or standing posture? What are your hands doing? Do you have churning or tightness in your gut?
- Pay attention to each physical sensation for a few moments. Notice whether each feeling shifts or changes during this period.
- Note how the desire for distraction or the chance to run away from emotion manifests itself. Tempted to pull out the phone? To jump into thought, logic, or planning? Turn to work or something that feels more "productive"?
- Repeat this practice at least three times per week. Keep a log of what situations trigger emotional responses, as well as how they feel afterward.

By building this foundation of awareness and sensitivity, Architects can develop the skills necessary to recognize their emotional needs, as well as those of their friends. As a result, they can better understand when to offer encouragement rather than advice, when to validate rather than contradict, and when to listen rather than strategize.

Emotion in Motion: Extra Credit

At times, Architects may want to initiate emotion-based conversations with their Analyst friends as a means of growing closer, clearing the air, or just increasing emotional intelligence. Fortunately, this doesn't have to be a harrowing, maudlin experience. Instead, Architects and their Analyst friends can approach it like a game:

- Download and print a circular "emotional range" chart. Such charts display various emotions or feelings, such as "remorseful" or "daring," and are easy to find through an Internet search.
- Tape the chart to a dart board.
- Take turns throwing darts.
- Tell an anecdote about a time you felt the emotion or feeling that your dart hit.

Although it might seem too simple to be effective, this type of conversation helps Architects and Analysts express aspects of their experience that they might not otherwise be able to discuss. Such conversations can build true bonds between friends, and when framed as a game, they can lead to a surprisingly good time.

Architect-Diplomat Friendships

Architects and Diplomats often have a rapid connection because they recognize in each other the ability to see beyond the superficial into deep, mysterious dimensions. Their main difference is that Diplomats tend to view the world in terms of human interactions and hopeful ideals, whereas Architects are more likely to coolly consider possibility tempered with probability. This difference is unlikely to derail their connection, however, and can even inspire new understanding for both friends.

Balanced Architect-Diplomat Friendships

Keeping It Fresh

Diplomats can be "gateway friends" who prove to Architects how much fun it is to hang out with people who aren't quite like them. The two often enjoy an immediate sense of kinship, given their insightfulness and shared passion for fresh ideas. In fact, Diplomats often tick many of Architects' boxes for ideal friends. Yet they can also help break down Architects' tendency to reduce people into checklists and categories, showing them the joy in diversity and inspiring them to appreciate individuals as they are.

Architects can take an unbalanced view of others, operating from the assumption that most people are boring, shallow, or even unintelligent. This mindset threatens to make their world quite small, blinding them to what everyone around them has to offer, from strangers sitting next to them on the train to those they encounter every day. Spotting such potential is Diplomats' specialty, so, for Architects, watching their Diplomat friends initiate conversations with tourists in their town and discover people's backstories can be eye-opening. Over time,

Diplomats are likely to draw some new people into their shared circle of friends. This may initially dismay Architects, but as they get to know the people better, they may well discover their deeper value. Either way, Architects' relationships with Diplomats run deep, allowing both friends to explore new terrain and grow in unexpected directions.

Getting to Know You

Architects who wish to make new friends do well to approach Diplomats. Open-hearted and welcoming, Diplomats enjoy getting to know new people, and they're unlikely to offer a harsh rebuff if someone expresses an interest in spending time with them. Architects may want to keep an eye out for people who display typical Diplomat traits – curiosity, warmth, and an effusive desire to help others – and get to know those people better. If they don't run across Diplomats by serendipity, Architects might find them at volunteer events, gallery openings, library and museum events, or meditation classes.

Fortunately, striking up conversations with Diplomats is relatively easy. Like Architects, they don't feel beholden to small talk, and they don't mind going deep. To get the conversation going, Architects might ask them about their interests, their passions, or their involvement with organizations. Chances are that Diplomats will welcome Architects' inquisitiveness and will express curiosity about them in return.

Unbalanced Architect-Diplomat Friendships

All the Feels

Architects often think of strong emotional expression as incompatible with truth, logic, or accomplishment – in other words, something to be "dealt with" rather than honored and integrated into their day-to-day lives. For their Diplomat friends, who consider emotion a critical way of connecting with others, this attitude can come across as cold and distant. When Diplomats try to unburden themselves emotionally, Architects may react awkwardly, change the subject, or offer advice rather than sympathy. Even when they truly want to help friends when they're upset, Architects can struggle to find words of support.

These differences can profoundly affect Architect-Diplomat friendships. Sensitive Diplomats might feel judged or dismissed, leading them to pull away from such relationships. On the other hand, Architects might feel exhausted after spending time with their emotionally expressive friends, eventually retreating from what they perceive as uncontrolled chaos.

Excuse Me?

Generally staunch in their views, Architects might see Diplomats as relatively persuadable or acquiescent. This isn't necessarily true: Diplomats may shy away from expressing disagreement, but that doesn't mean they'll yield to the opinions of others. In fact, they can have strongly held ideals and principles, especially Judging Diplomats.

If Architects alienate their Diplomat friends by harshly disagreeing with them or criticizing something important to them, the resulting rift may be deep and difficult to repair. Especially sensitive Diplomats may not be able to tolerate even constructive criticism or well-intended feedback. In response, Architects might push harder, trying to prove the rationality or "rightness" of their perspective. The results are often resentment and disappointment on both sides.

Rebalancing Architect-Diplomat Friendships

Support + Validation + Encouragement

Architects don't love talking about their feelings – and, in many situations, that's perfectly fine. That said, they can shortchange their friendships, particularly their friendships with Diplomats, if they shut down every conversation about feelings. Diplomats look to such discussions as opportunities to express their authentic selves, and relationships feel shallow to them if they don't feel free to emotionally unburden themselves when necessary.

As they mature and become more attuned to others' needs, Architects recognize that Diplomats can struggle in relationships with people who could be considered the emotional equivalent of a brick wall. At times, friendship with Diplomats requires offering validation, support, and encouragement. Fortunately, Architects are perfectly capable of

comforting their Diplomat friends who are going through tough times – even if it doesn't always feel easy or comfortable.

Here's how Architects can meet Diplomats' emotional needs while staying true to themselves:

- Use the formula: validation + support + encouragement.
- Start with validation, which means demonstrating awareness and understanding of what others are experiencing. The first step is to listen carefully, taking care not to interrupt them or unnecessarily discredit what they're saying. Remember, everyone is entitled to their experiences, and others' feelings are never wrong, even if they don't seem helpful or rational. To express validation, simply reiterate the emotions others are expressing, without judgment or minimization. For example, "It sounds like you've had a tough time of it," or, "It sounds like you're really hurt."
- Progress to support, which can be as simple as saying, "I'm here for you." Even if it feels awkward to say it, or even if it seems as if others should know it already, Diplomats benefit immensely from such outward expressions.
- End with encouragement, which is an unconditional offering of future support; in other words, "When you want to make a change, I will help you – if you want my help."

Even if Architects feel uncomfortable or overwhelmed in such conversations, Diplomats can sense their good intentions. By following the formula of *validation* + *support* + *encouragement*, Architects can be there for their friends in the way Diplomats crave.

Preventing "Foot-in-Mouth Disease"

Architects may be surprised to discover just how much their unflinching honesty can wound sensitive Diplomats, who may take criticism and disagreement personally. Fortunately, if Architects take a few simple precautions when voicing their opinions, their incisiveness can be an asset to their relationships.

Rather than indulging in the ego-stroking that some people use to form bonds, Architects offer directness as an expression of respect.

Because it comes from a place of integrity and authenticity, their candor can endear them to their friends. In an age of gossip, social veneers, and worship of appearances, their unvarnished honesty can be refreshing – yes, even for Diplomats. By expressing their thoughts carefully and respectfully, Architects can ensure that their ideas and feedback help their Diplomat friends, rather than triggering defensiveness or hurt.

So how can people with this personality type bring the benefits of their directness to their friendships without alienating Diplomats? It's easier not to say something in the first place than to take it back, so Architects can try putting themselves through the following mental hurdles beforehand:

- Consider whether there's a real benefit to correcting or criticizing a friend at this time. Are they able to receive feedback right now, or are they emotionally triggered or upset? If it's the latter, speaking up would likely backfire.
- Avoid interrupting to offer an opinion. Interrupting someone might seem like a time-saving measure – especially if they're rambling – but it puts them on the defensive, making the conversation less productive overall.
- Never offer criticism or hard-to-swallow opinions to those in emotional distress. Signs of emotional distress include a noticeably fast or slow pace of speaking, crossed arms or a hunched posture, and, of course, crying.
- When in doubt, ask, "Would you like to hear what I think?" before stepping in. Remember that Diplomats might find it difficult to say "no" outright, so if they show reluctance, hold off until a few hours – or days – later.

Architects' directness can be a gift, but sometimes discretion is the better part of valor. Fortunately, they are willing to think before they speak, which enables them to prevent "foot-in-mouth disease" in the first place. By running through the points above before sharing criticism or feedback with their Diplomat friends, Architects can save their insights for situations where they will truly be of benefit.

Architect-Sentinel Friendships

Under the right circumstances, Architects find that Sentinels complement them very well as friends. Sentinels can help ground them, offering the stability, consistency, and pragmatism that many Architects crave in their relationships. In return, Architects enjoy the opportunity to expand Sentinels' awareness beyond the mastery of pragmatic, tangible concerns, helping them develop their own creativity and imagination.

Balanced Architect-Sentinel Friendships

A Solid Foundation

Architects and Sentinels might seem like an odd match, given Architects' thirst for innovation and Sentinels' respect for tradition and protocol. But beneath the surface, the two share similar desires for their friendships. Both value loyalty and consistency, and although Architects may not possess the social graces that Sentinels uphold, well-rounded Sentinels appreciate the other traits that Architects offer – for example, their willingness to help friends in concrete ways.

Their similarities create a solid foundation for friendship, with each type trusting the other to have their back. Architects know that Sentinels will show up for them, whether it's helping them move or encouraging them to focus on what they can do in the present moment when they feel overwhelmed. In return, Sentinels appreciate that Architects take the time to understand things and act with forethought, often serving as stabilizing, foundational influences for their loved ones. These friendships can stand the test of time, holding strong through life changes and time pressures that tend to drive so many other types of friends apart.

Follow-Through

In a world that can seem like all talk and no follow-through, Architects and Sentinels recognize each other as take-charge, kindred spirits. This creates an important baseline of respect in their friendship, because both Architects and Sentinels chafe at spending time around people who fall short of their standards. For Architects, close Sentinel friendships can be a refuge from all those in their lives who seem flaky or inconsistent, or those who refuse to deal with difficult problems.

Thanks to their shared, results-driven mindset, Architects and Sentinels follow through on their plans to spend time together. They don't make non-committal comments like, "We should hang out sometime," which characterizes many friendships. As a result, they share experiences and bond in ways that make sense to them, actively sustaining and developing their relationships rather than simply paying them lip service.

Unbalanced Architect-Sentinel Friendships

Snap Judgments

Sadly, superficial differences can dissuade Architects and Sentinels from realizing their friendship potential. Architects love to discuss and analyze hypothetical scenarios, whereas Sentinels prioritize common-sense issues. To Sentinels, Architects can seem bafflingly out of touch with everyday truths. Unless Architects have cultivated flexibility and open-mindedness in themselves, they may roll their eyes at Sentinels' respect for societal expectations.

As a result, the two might not click when they first meet. Even Architects in search of new friends may write off Sentinels, assuming they're too pedestrian, stodgy, or boring to be a match. Because Architects are at risk of externalizing or projecting such judgments, they can quickly alienate themselves from potential Sentinel pals.

For example, Architect students might think less of Sentinel classmates who devote themselves to something as "pointless" as the prom committee, and Architect employees might lose respect for coworkers they perceive as "having no imagination" – hardly the best

starting conditions for close comradery. That is a shame, given that Sentinels have the potential to be true, steadfast friends to Architects who have an open mind.

Clashing Values

Architects tend to be more irreverent and skeptical than tradition-minded Sentinels, which can create tension between them, particularly because these friends may both have mild (or not so mild) disdain for those who don't see things their way. In general, Architects love to question the institutions that many Sentinels hold dear: religion, government, social norms and conventions, etc. Many Sentinels are understandably resistant when others try to upend their worldview or negate their values.

This dynamic plays out in an obvious way when Architects point out logical inconsistencies that underpin Sentinels' values and beliefs. Although they're just trying to be accurate, they can damage their friendships if their Sentinel friends feel attacked, belittled, or patronized.

This dynamic can also harm their friendships in less obvious ways. For example, Architects might try to push their Sentinel friends to have less "conventional" dreams: "Why settle for two kids, a 9-to-5 job, and a white picket fence when you could be an astronaut/entrepreneur/CEO?" However well intended, such comments can imply that Sentinels' aspirations aren't good enough, leaving these friends feeling defensive or unsupported. Architects can indeed broaden Sentinels' horizons, but they need to do so with respect for their existing values and priorities. Otherwise, they risk pushing away their Sentinel friends.

Rebalancing Architect-Sentinel Friendships

Befriending Sentinels

Architects tend to have clear visions of what they want in their friends, and they might conclude that Sentinels won't match their vision. Unfortunately, this mindset closes Architects off from rewarding social interactions, including friendships, with a significant portion of the

population. It also keeps them in an echo chamber, where they aren't challenged by alternative points of view or different personalities – even when those alternate perspectives reflect societal norms.

Fortunately, Architects don't need to be coddled, and they don't expect constant validation. In addition, they see the utility of diverse friendships. They know they have weaknesses just as everyone does, and they're rational enough to recognize that they can benefit from friends who have strengths in other areas. As a result, Architects who want to feel more grounded in their home lives or their communities may wish to seek out friendships with Sentinels, who excel in such areas.

Architects can promote open-mindedness – and get to know Sentinels on a deeper level – by doing the following:

- When talking with Sentinel acquaintances, think of yourself as an interviewer, gently steering the conversation from small talk to things that truly matter to your conversation partner. Chatting with Sentinels who host local events about their desire to bring their community together can help Architects appreciate that Sentinels act on principle, not just to fulfill social obligations or pressures.
- Look for common ground. Ask Sentinels what they hope to achieve through their work or other activities. Chances are they'll have gratifyingly specific answers.
- Even though they make up a significant portion of the population, Sentinels can be outsiders or underdogs – and many Architects can relate. If the Sentinel in question seems relatively comfortable and self-assured, gently turn the conversation toward times they've persevered despite experiencing difficulties. Sentinels don't often call attention to their determination, but they enjoy speaking about it when given the opportunity, and it's a trait that Architects generally find admirable.

Of course, not every Sentinel will be a match for every Architect – and that's perfectly OK. But by using these conversational techniques, Architects can break beneath their surface differences, find common ground, and identify Sentinels who may be compatible as friends.

R-E-S-P-E-C-T

Diverse friendships are a gift in part because they make us question ourselves. Do our choices make us feel fulfilled and happy, or would we be better off if we tried a different way of living? Is our definition of a "good life" really the best for everyone? Architects generally recognize the utility of confronting and re-assessing their assumptions, so they can appreciate the way Sentinel friends force them to do so in their conversations.

Even if they don't directly address their differences, these two can enjoy surprisingly pleasurable friendships, based on respect and mutuality. It's important to remember that different friendships serve different needs, and not every friend must fulfill every need. Sentinels might not "get" Architects' unconventional manners and aspirations, and they might not love the hypothetical conversations that make Architects' hearts beat faster, but that doesn't diminish the fact that these friends can have fun going to the movies together or grabbing a cup of coffee. Whatever their differences, these two can still enjoy each other's company and offer practical, well-intended support when it's needed.

Expecting all rewarding relationships to be founded on perfect compatibility is an impossible ideal, and recognizing this can ease the pressure and brighten friendships. To reframe their attitude accordingly, Architects can try the following steps:

- Pay attention to what types of activities and conversations are especially enjoyable with Sentinel friends.
- Express appreciation for such moments out loud. This can be as simple as, "I'm glad we were able to see that movie together," or, "Thanks for following up about getting dinner together. I'm glad we made it happen."
- Note how you feel before and after spending time with your Sentinel friend, and express gratitude for any positive shifts: "My mind was all over the place earlier today, and now I'm feeling a lot less stressed. Thanks for that."

Such moments of appreciation are touching to Sentinels, and voicing such thoughts aloud reminds Architects of the strengths of their friendship.

Architect-Explorer Friendships

Architect-Explorer friendships aren't always instant fits, but they have a lot of potential, especially if the two share common interests. Architects often struggle to let go of compulsive analyses and simply have fun, but they can look to Explorer friends to help them approach the world with enthusiasm and unworried curiosity. They, in turn, can help Explorers see their deeper potential and consider the consequences of their actions. Setting sail is a grand adventure, but Explorers need someone beside them who knows how to navigate; these two can be excellent partners in discovery.

Balanced Architect-Explorer Friendships

Appreciating Diverse Strengths

In truly fulfilling friendships, Architects appreciate that their friends' strengths differ from their own, admiring their unique and impressive qualities on an individual basis. This is especially apparent in friendships with Explorers, whose strengths include a thirst for adventure and the ability to take deep pleasure from the present moment – two traits that don't come naturally to Architects. Many Explorers also enjoy a natural, almost automatic sociability that Architects must work to develop.

When they take an open-minded approach, Architects recognize the value of such gifts, allowing their Explorer friends to be their true selves, even if their "true selves" aren't quite as rational or consistent as Architects might prefer. This appreciation of diverse merits helps Architects grow. By spending time with Explorer friends, Architects can expand their awareness of the world, engaging with fresh ideas and possibilities.

A Pleasant Surprise

Explorers can be great fun. Spontaneous and action oriented, they break Architects out of their shells and take them on unexpected, memorable adventures – something many Architects crave. It can be tempting to think that rationality is incompatible with lighthearted fun, but this is hardly the case. Beneath their rational exteriors, Architects thrum with wit and irreverent humor, and they enjoy a good time as much as anyone. By helping Architects relax and enjoy themselves, Explorers remind them of their true natures. For Architects who feel alone or underappreciated, time with Explorers can be exactly what they need to revive their self-esteem.

Initiating friendships with Explorers can be surprisingly validating for Architects. Most Explorers are curious about new people, making them relatively easy to engage in conversation. Even typically distant Virtuosos can light up when talking about their passions with Architects. Many Explorers are in the habit of inviting people places, so they tend to be receptive to Architects who suggest hanging out together, especially if the get-togethers involve visiting new places or trying new activities. As their friendships develop, Architects may find that a bit of Explorers' easygoing, sociable attitude rubs off on them – and, much to their surprise, that they enjoy it.

Unbalanced Architect-Explorer Friendships

Different Visions of Quality Time

If Architects are risk averse, their reluctance to try new things, venture beyond their social comfort zones, or entertain other points of view can make it difficult for them to bond with free-minded Explorers. Although Explorers are always looking for opportunities to share experiences with the people who matter to them, Architects sometimes need to recharge by staying home, visiting an old haunt, or reading a book – reflecting a need for consistency and alone time that some Explorers may not understand. If the two don't see eye to eye, neither one is too likely to put the other first and compromise for the sake of harmony.

Explorers, the Extraverted ones in particular, might push Architects to go out more, do more, and try new things. If Architects go along with the requests, they risk exhaustion; if they decline, they risk alienating their friends. When Architects turn down Explorers' invitations to try new things, Explorers might take it personally, interpreting it as a distancing maneuver. After all, Explorers look to shared experiences and activities as ways to bond. But Architects might not realize that spending quality time out and about with Explorers is essential to maintaining their friendship. Without maintenance, the relationships can wither – leaving both feeling disappointed, even rejected.

The Rigid and the Reckless

Architects might wonder whether their Explorer friends think of them as stodgy or boring. Explorers live in the moment, and they love to act on their desires. For some, this might mean checking out an expensive new restaurant they can't really afford. For more reckless Explorers, adventures might entail bridge jumping, rock climbing without taking proper precautions, or quitting a job without a backup plan. Regardless of what form it takes, Architects may see Explorers' spontaneity and risk-taking as dangerously shortsighted and stressfully unpredictable.

This isn't the foundation for a good friendship. Architects can too easily fall into the role of the "stooge," acting almost like parents as they criticize their Explorer friends for not being more responsible. This can spur Explorers to be more reckless in an effort to prove their independence. The friends react rather than respond to each other, with neither type showing up as the best versions of themselves. Inevitably, Architects tire of caretaking and Explorers tire of Architects' judgments, and one or both pull away.

Rebalancing Architect-Explorer Friendships

Experiment

If Architects push themselves to keep up with their most exuberant Explorer friends' adventures, they'll burn out. After all, they need to recharge by spending at least some time on their own. Moreover, their opinionated nature can make it difficult for them to feel excited about the concerts, art openings, or other events that their Explorer friends

suggest attending. That said, if Architects don't make any effort to share experiences with their Explorer friends, then their friendship will eventually fade. As mature Architects know, lasting relationships require effort and compromise.

As a first step, Architects can set goals for how often they take the initiative and suggest shared activities that appeal to them. This makes them active participants in their relationships and ensures that they aren't always going along with Explorers' whims. Moreover, Explorers might be flattered by their invitations, especially if they're usually the ones who initiate activities.

As a second step, Architects might set a goal for how many times they will say yes to Explorers' invitations. For example, they may aim to join in at least once a week, or they might decide to say yes to at least one out of three invitations. Without this type of benchmark, it's easy to put off spending quality time with Explorer friends. Fortunately, Architects are goal oriented, and when they commit to maintaining their friendships, they follow through.

To strengthen their commitment to trying new things with Explorers, Architects might consider the following reframing exercise:

- Re-label adventures as experiments. Choose a "lab notebook" in which to record observations.
- Identify a question that the experience can answer (for example, "Will trail running raise my heart rate higher than road running?").
- If time permits, consider researching the activity. Learning about trail-running strategies and records, for example, might make the experience more interesting.
- Create a hypothesis for the above question. Decide how to measure the results.
- Involve the Explorer in the experiment, if possible.
- Note the results.
- Revisit the hypothesis and revise accordingly.
- If possible, conduct a follow-up experiment to verify results.

In their own way, Architects care about being there for their friends. By sharing new experiences with Explorers, they can broaden their horizons – and deepen their friendships.

How About This?

Architects can take charge of their outings with Explorers by regularly proposing activities that suit their interests and meet their standards. That way, they won't make their Explorer friends think they don't want to spend time together – and, just as importantly, they won't suffer through as many outings they don't enjoy, which can cause them to feel resentful or frustrated with their friends.

If their Explorer friends want to wander into the backwoods to camp and forage wild edibles, for example, Architects can say "no thanks" this time, but another time offer to reserve an actual campsite with access to legendary trails (and to bring food!). Architects who find themselves turning down invitations – to concerts featuring artists or genres they don't enjoy, perhaps – can turn offers around and suggest performances by artists they admire.

Here's how Architects can propose more activities that they and their Explorer friends can enjoy together:

- Every time you turn down an Explorer friend's invitation, make a note of the type of event or outing offered (for example, an outdoor adventure, a music performance, or an overnight trip).
- Research an alternative that sounds more enjoyable – a concert by a performer you respect or an overnight trip to a place you'd like to visit.
- Finally, suggest the event or activity to your Explorer friend, explaining why it excites you.
- In addition, when researching personal interests, keep an eye out for in-person events, openings, performances, and workshops, and ask Explorer friends if they'd like to come along.

This approach allows Architects to temper their desire for control with spontaneity, particularly because they can depend on their Explorer

friends to liven up the experiences. That said, please note that this strategy is designed for use in tandem with the one above (turning an activity into an experiment). At times, Architects benefit from saying "yes" to their Explorer friends' ideas – especially if those ideas require them to venture beyond their comfort zones.

Conclusion

Architects may be known for their independence, but that doesn't mean they have to spend all their time alone. When they open themselves to understanding and appreciating people with whom they may not share easy or immediate compatibility, they discover a world of people who can offer good company, fresh perspectives, and consistent support. Friendships can be a much-needed source of happiness and personal fulfillment for Architects, allowing them to develop open-mindedness, emotional awareness, and a sense of true belonging – all of which are important steps in their personal growth.

In return, Architects bring many gifts to their friendships. Although emotional demonstrations don't come easily to them, they communicate their care through their respect and loyalty toward their friends, as well as a willingness to step in and offer insightful yet practical help whenever it's needed. An offer of friendship from an Architect indicates deep appreciation and commitment; it isn't to be taken lightly.

Branching Out

Although Architects might assume that they should look for friends who share their values, interests, and approaches to life, that isn't necessarily the case. Their unique combination of traits makes them rational and curious but not always open-minded, and they have deep values and a tendency to want to change the world to suit their own rational preferences.

Friendships with people who don't completely share their perspective might not provide obvious reassurance, but ultimately, such relationships create even greater gains. Although Architects are known for their unconventional ideas, their creativity stalls if they surround themselves only with like-minded individuals. As they grow,

they come to respect capability and accomplishment in many forms, which allows for friendships with people whose strengths differ from their own. By consciously engaging with others who challenge their worldview, Architects expand their minds, achieve new perspectives, and increase their abilities.

For Architects, however, friendship isn't just about intellectual expansion. They also crave trustworthy friends who listen to them, stick with them through thick and thin, allow them to be their authentic selves, and bring fun and enjoyment to their lives. By cultivating open-mindedness and emotional intelligence, Architects can learn how to establish deep, meaningful friendships – and maintain them over a lifetime.

Parenthood

Truthful and Decisive

As individualistic as Architects can be, as parents they're also remarkably honest, respectful, and motivating. They aren't a personality type that hovers over their children, always swooping in to solve problems for them. Instead, Architect parents recognize that life is often the best teacher, so they tend to encourage their children to have their own adventures and to develop critical thinking skills by making their own decisions.

This isn't to say that Architect parents are lenient – far from it. They expect their children to use their freedom responsibly. The weight of this expectation alone is often enough to convey the ground rules, without their ever having to voice them. When necessary, however, Architect parents speak openly and honestly with their children. To them, teaching their kids the truth is better than instilling ignorance – or, worse yet, the wrong lesson.

Innovative and Open-Minded

Architects promote independence and self-sufficiency in their children from a very young age. They want to raise competent, intelligent individuals capable of critical and independent thinking. As innovators themselves, Architects provide their children with critical thinking tools, with the hope they'll eventually attempt to analyze some of the world's larger problems – think global warming or a cure for cancer. These parents help their children establish their own independent problem-solving skills that they can apply to increasingly complex situations as they mature.

Although Architects tend to believe that they're the most well-informed people in the room, they can also be incredibly accepting and supportive of their children's independent pursuits and beliefs. If their kids approach everything they do with curiosity, their parents will support their intellectual journeys, even when they neither understand nor entirely agree with their kids. Understanding that their children won't necessarily share their ideals, beliefs, or thinking style, mature Architects encourage their children to arrive at their own conclusions.

Impatient and Overly Rational

Parenting, like so many other relationships, can be a challenge for Architects. Heavily invested in rational thought and logic as they are, they can be unprepared for dealing with the irrationalities of children – and as parents, it's not as if they can simply walk away whenever they want. Patience with others isn't among Architects' strengths, and they might find interactions with irrational or unreasonable kids particularly frustrating and exhausting.

Architects prize self-determination and intelligent action above just about all else. They value and often expect clarity and emotional stability in others. They believe that the right solution is the most efficient one, and they have trouble withholding their opinions on how things should be done – an issue that can persist even when their children are fully grown. Parents who rely on rationality can alienate emotionally sensitive children by discounting their feelings.

Lacking Emotional Intelligence

Architects who identify as objective, calculating perfectionists can be insensitive and neglect demonstrative physical affection. It takes a clear, conscious effort on their part to adapt to their children's needs, especially during the younger years. They risk inadvertently trampling their kids' sensitivities or coming across as cold, uncaring, or unreasonably strict.

What if their children don't enjoy intellectual puzzles, books, grand strategy, or science? What if their children are impulsive and downright emotional, behaving in ways that seem utterly irrational – but are, in fact, perfectly natural parts of development? Architect parents can struggle when interacting with children who don't appear to share

their dominant personality traits. They may even end up relying on their spouses or partners to compensate for their weaknesses rather than developing these relationship skills themselves.

Finding Ways to Connect

Patience with others may not come easily to them, but Architect parents can still build positive, mutually beneficial ties with their children. With their passion for problem-solving and strategizing, those who take the time to seek out resources, information, and even advice from trusted sources can connect with their children in meaningful ways.

Although they're not often inclined to initiate or reciprocate physical contact, Architects who dedicate themselves to connecting with their children can find ways to be affectionate and intentionally interactive. Sharing hobbies with their kids, such as playing board games, reading together, or hiking, are perfect opportunities for these parents to not only bond with their children but also pass on their values, beliefs, and ideas.

Committing to Understanding Themselves and Others

Architects are uniquely capable of committing to a long-term project, especially one as meaningful as parenthood, with all the intellectual vigor they can muster. In certain cases, however, parents with this personality type must learn to adapt to a more sensitive approach – and quickly. Suppressing emotions doesn't eliminate them; those feelings inevitably re-emerge, unaddressed and untamed. Architect parents should try to acknowledge their children's emotions – even those that seem irrational – as well as their own.

It's helpful for Architects to remember that emotions, like all thoughts, have a neurochemical basis. Though expressing feelings is difficult for them, emotional literacy can fit into their overarching philosophy of intelligent self-direction. By encouraging their children to deal with feelings responsibly and honestly, they can advance their ultimate mission as parents: to nurture their children into capable, self-sufficient adults. Architects understand that such growth can't happen if they shield their children from every source of ill and harm, but they believe that by giving their children the right tools, they won't have to.

Parenting for Each Stage of Development

Each stage of children's growth presents both unique challenges and exciting milestones. Learning how to navigate the stages can seem daunting, but the opportunity to build a healthy attachment and create meaningful memories makes it worth the struggle.

Renowned psychologist Erik Erikson proposed a theory of psychosocial development that identifies eight stages, five of which take place between birth and 18 years of age. It's important to remember that the stages aren't set in stone, and the ages listed for each stage are approximate. Children develop at their own pace and meet each milestone in their own time. They often skip stages, achieve them in an unexpected order, or try one milestone out, then fall back to an old one – especially common with walking. Unpredictability in development is often normal, and developing a healthy relationship with a pediatric physician can help parents answer any lingering questions and concerns.

The following sections discuss what to expect during each stage of development, as well as how the strengths and weaknesses of the Architect personality type can affect parenting at each stage.

Building Bonds (Birth–1½ Years)

According to Erikson, the stages of infancy and early childhood last from birth until approximately three years of age. Children in these stages are very dependent on their parents for their survival. This is also when parents create the bonds of attachment by meeting their children's needs, developing trusting relationships, and promoting autonomy.

The priority for infants in the journey to attachment is having their basic needs met. From being fed to receiving affection, babies learn to either trust that their Architect parents will provide for them, or they'll suffer from a sense of mistrust in their subsequent relationships. If children at this stage are inconsistently cared for or neglected, they can have difficulty creating positive, trusting attachments with their parents and any other subsequent relationships.

On the other hand, attentive and affectionate parents – especially those who engage in consistent physical contact such as snuggling

and transporting their children in baby carriers on their bodies – encourage trusting, hopeful relationships with their infants, and they are likely to have very little difficulty building comfortable attachments.

Balanced Infant Parenting

Efficient and Strategic

Architects excel at providing efficient structure, and they're able to take a balanced approach to parenting by adapting these skills to meet their babies' needs. Consistency is key in building relationships with infants, and these parents are likely to be very attentive by reliably feeding, changing, and comforting them when necessary. They tend to find both efficient and effective methods of child care, and they work to build the trust necessary for their children to move into their next stage of development.

As strategic thinkers, Architects also do an excellent job of planning for their children's long-term needs. Parenting is about more than just meeting kids' immediate requirements; Architect parents consider what their babies will need three months, five years, and 18 years into the future. From researching the best preschools in the area to setting up a savings account for future college expenses, these parents start planning on day one to ensure their children's future success.

High Achievers

Architects want to do more than a good job – they want to do the *best job possible* in any endeavor they pursue. This includes parenthood – being "OK" parents isn't an option for Architects, and their passion for high achievement drives them to be the best parents they can. Their maternal or paternal drive activates within the first few months after their children are born, and the infancy stage is all about setting both themselves and their children up for a happy and successful future.

A desire to be competent and productive motivates Architects, and when motivated they can be unstoppable in their ability to gather information and refine their skills. From reading parenting books and blogs to practicing diaper changing and techniques for putting babies to sleep, they're prepared to parent. This preparation translates into

more confidence in their ability to care for their infants, as well as the ability to build greater bonds with their growing children.

Unbalanced Infant Parenting

Struggling with Affection

Although they're extraordinarily attentive and reliable, Architect parents may need to focus on regularly providing intentional affection. During the infant stage, babies who don't receive adequate physical contact from caregivers struggle with bonding and trust. In severe cases, infants who aren't provided with loving physical contact can experience a "failure to thrive," which results in emotional, intellectual, and behavioral issues that can hinder their future relationships.

Most Architect parents are unlikely to completely deprive their children of physical contact, but they may see interactions with their infants as necessary responsibilities rather than opportunities to promote bonding. They may be tempted to let their children "cry it out" when it's time for them to sleep – especially when they're feeling sleep-deprived themselves. That technique may work well for some, but not for all children, especially those who need extra physical contact for comfort or relaxation – they may respond more positively to rocking or a soothing lullaby. Adapting to their babies' unique needs during this time can be especially frustrating for Architects, especially if they feel that a research-based method *should* meet their children's needs.

Unreasonable Expectations

In addition to struggling with expressing affection, parents with the Architect personality type may have unrealistic expectations regarding what their children are capable of at this stage. Although they certainly understand their infants' theoretical capabilities at this point in their development, they may expect them to achieve certain milestones more quickly than is necessary, or they may fret that their children aren't hitting milestones "on time." As high achievers themselves, these parents are prone to believing that their children will reach similar heights – and these expectations start at the beginning of their children's lives.

It's certainly exciting to see their babies roll over for the first time, sit up on their own, or expertly stack their periodic table element blocks, but pushing children toward early milestones can cause frustration for everyone involved. Just because their infants aren't saying their first words at the same time as their friends' children are, it doesn't mean that they aren't as intelligent. Development, especially at this stage, is about so much more than measuring parental ability or children's potential. Both Architect parents and their infants can be much happier and more relaxed if they're allowed to grow and develop at their own pace.

Rebalancing Infant Parenting

Interacting with Affection

Architects are highly motivated, and they tend to excel at parenting children through the infancy stage if they take the proper steps for overcoming their potential weaknesses. They're generally hesitant to express their emotions, but innocent children – especially those who reciprocate their feelings through smiles, giggles, and other positive reactions – can bring out these parents' sensitive, silly, loving sides.

Affection may come naturally to some types, but Architects can struggle to activate their loving natures. Fortunately, infants are fantastic catalysts for promoting fondness as well as prompting adults to speak in silly baby voices. Even stoic, serious individuals often loosen up and express their emotions more freely after they have children.

The following techniques can be effective for promoting both affection and bonding between Architect parents and their infants:

- Reciprocate your children's laughter, facial expressions, and even hand motions. Infants bond by instinctively mimicking facial expressions, a phenomenon called "mirroring."
- Cuddle and keep your infants close in wearable child-carriers.
- Speak in a soothing voice, sing, and encourage eye contact. These physical gestures will help you foster attachment with your babies.

Physical affection is one of the most important ways to both build attachment and promote infant growth and development. For Architects who typically shy away from human contact, there's an added benefit of focusing on this type of interaction – they're tapping into their innate desire to love and be loved. Hormones released during physical contact promote feelings of acceptance and love that create indelible bonds between parents and children.

Providing Supportive Encouragement

At this stage, it's important for Architects to understand that developmental milestones are approximate, not set in stone. Additionally, children who attain certain milestones earlier aren't necessarily "advanced," and those who achieve them later aren't always "delayed." Labeling children as "advanced" or "delayed" can be detrimental to their development, as well as their self-esteem, throughout their lives. There's absolutely nothing wrong with Architects having high expectations of their children, if they temper those expectations with understanding and acceptance.

Children at every developmental stage need unconditional love and acceptance from their parents, and it's critical for infants. Architect parents should turn their attention to providing the support children need to grow their skills at their own pace and set aside their concerns about achievement and aptitude. Support, at this stage, consists of accepting where their children are developmentally, providing regular and consistent encouragement.

The following are examples of how Architects can organically encourage their infants while still accepting their current abilities:

- Introduce items that encourage interaction, such as blocks, rattles, puzzles, and age-appropriate musical instruments (like toy drums).
- Talk to infants frequently – explain how the food is being prepared, talk about the weather outside, or describe what is happening when they interact with a toy. Conversation, whether they understand what is being said or not, promotes language development and creates a special bond between parents and children by increasing engagement.

- Read to babies at every opportunity. Children love stories, and reading to infants is one of the easiest and most meaningful ways to interact with them, while also encouraging language development and promoting visual stimulation.

Encouragement and acceptance aren't mutually exclusive – it's possible to both promote infants' growth while still accepting the (completely normal) limitations of their current abilities.

There may be times, however, when Architect parents should be concerned about their children's development or lack thereof. In such instances, conversations should be had with family physicians or pediatricians to determine what issues are present and to develop a plan to address those issues.

Testing Boundaries (1½–3 Years)

Once they're mobile, young children become very interested in exploring their environment with their senses. Crawling, walking, grabbing items, putting things in their mouths, and communicating verbally are just a few of the ways that toddlers learn about the world around them.

During this stage, Architect parents must provide a safe harbor for their children while still allowing them to experience and explore their surroundings. Children who can test boundaries while still receiving parental support and encouragement develop a sense of autonomy. Those who are overly restricted, criticized, or made to feel guilty for their desire to test boundaries tend to experience a sense of shame, and they may suffer from feelings of incompetence or low self-worth. Such feelings can last throughout their lives and may ultimately jeopardize their ability to achieve goals and develop positive character traits such as reliability or confidence.

Balanced Toddler Parenting

Eagerly Encouraging Learning

Increasing knowledge is a high priority for Architects, and they're always encouraging their children to engage in activities where they

can learn something as well. The exploration stage is an exciting one for parents and children alike as they witness meaningful milestones such as talking, walking, and learning how to use toys and utensils. Architect parents, in particular, are known to provide their children with plenty of stimulation and opportunities for exploration.

From reading science-fiction bedtime stories to explaining life lessons, Architects are likely to incorporate learning into every activity they do with their children, who benefit tremendously from the wisdom, tolerance, and protection of their parents. These experiences increase their toddlers' knowledge and create secure bonds between them. The more positive experiences that little ones have learning with their parents, the more likely they are to seek out their own educational experiences in the future. Architects who invest their time in encouraging their toddlers' growth and learning – especially when they play a supporting role to their children's own missions – lay the foundation for their sons and daughters to be successful and motivated in the future.

Open-Minded and Curious

Architects as a type are open-minded and easily intrigued – they're just as interested in exploration as their children, albeit in their more cerebral fashion. This shared desire to explore the world around them can provide incredible opportunities for both intellectual and emotional bonding. Architect parents have no problem understanding their toddlers' desires to test boundaries and can provide the safe "home base" that their children need while still encouraging their curiosity.

Many parents feel frustrated when their young children learn to question everything (seriously, *everything*) and make their own opinions known. Not so for Architects, who tend to feel a twinge of pride when their children ask questions that indicate a desire to learn more. These parents are more than willing to entertain questions or challenges from children. Though they certainly expect their kids to respect their authority – toddlers won't be granted this consideration mid-tantrum, for instance – little ones who ask thoughtful questions or raise objections for good reasons often receive thoughtful responses from their Architect parents.

Unbalanced Toddler Parenting

Authority Issues

For Architects who are insecure in their parenting abilities, this stage can be especially challenging, as they may have trouble if their children are disrespectful. The defiance of their children can feel like a direct assault on their authority – or worse yet, a rejection of their love. With their emotions so deeply hidden beneath the surface, parents with the Architect personality type may not even realize that they want their children to reciprocate love and acceptance. People with this personality type show their love by providing guidance – often in an authoritative form – and knowledge. So if they don't receive the proper respect, they may question whether their children truly love them.

Architects aren't offended by their children's desire to challenge the rules; however, this doesn't mean that they accept disrespectful behavior that they believe undermines their authority. This personality type can be inflexible, and they may find that their children's constant challenging of rules and boundaries causes tremendous tension. It doesn't help when their toddlers acquire "No!" as a new favorite word they can use forcefully and frequently. Architects who view challenges to their authority from their children as a rejection of love or respect may find this stage of child development to be one of the most difficult to endure.

Impatience with Toddler "Logic"

Architects understand that toddlers have limited cognitive abilities because of their development at this stage, but that doesn't always prevent them from becoming impatient with their little ones' newfound and shaky "logic." Irrational arguments are a pet peeve for this personality type, and toddlers are masters of this form of conflict. Although some types can overlook the irrational comments that toddlers make, Architect parents are more susceptible to frustration, which can quickly escalate to anger, criticism, and punishment – often making the situation more difficult.

Toddlers are notorious for lying or arguing about ridiculous things. A three-year-old may yell at their parents, insisting they aren't pouring their cereal on the floor even as they do just that. Such a blatant lie

can upset anyone, but Architects with unrealistic expectations of their children's cognitive development can find such illogical or irrational statements especially frustrating. When Architect parents deal with their toddlers' misbehavior in critical ways, rather than using it as an educational opportunity, their children are likely to become withdrawn, resentful, and even more likely to misbehave.

Rebalancing Toddler Parenting

Promoting Autonomy Through Positive Discipline

It's easy to become frustrated when children appear to constantly question those in control, but it's important to understand the necessity of testing boundaries at this stage. Toddlers need to learn how to act independently and become self-reliant, and they do this by testing their parents' authority. At this stage, they seek both security and increasing autonomy, and Architects need to tow the fine line between patiently supporting their children's desire to explore and upholding important rules to ensure safety. Toddlers who willfully disregard their parents' requests to stop throwing their toys aren't doing so out of a lack of love or respect for their parents; rather, they're testing the boundaries that their parents have put in place.

Being a source of authority is important, but promoting their children's autonomy in healthy ways is done more effectively through supportive, understanding communication and positive discipline. It helps to look at the use of authority, specifically disciplinary actions, as learning opportunities for children rather than forms of punishment.

Redirection is one of the most effective tools parents can use when dealing with toddlers. Unlike distraction, where parents simply try to find something else to occupy their children's attention, redirection focuses on addressing the underlying issue and finding a workable alternative solution. This method can be used as a preventative measure by considering alternatives in advance, as well as an in-the-moment solution, as the following example illustrates:

- Imagine a toddler is upset because they can't have a cookie before dinner, and they begin yelling.

- Resist the urge to yell back or put them in time-out.
- Make eye contact, and speak in a calm voice, saying, "I hear you saying that you would like a cookie. It isn't OK to yell, so let's both talk about this using our quiet voices."
- Consider the underlying cause of the child's anger. If the child is asking for a cookie, odds are that they're hungry – and hungry children are notoriously grumpy.
- Find a workable solution for all parties. Is there a healthier snack they can have? Could they taste some of the dinner that's being prepared? Would a glass of water help?
- Once the child calms down, reiterate that yelling isn't how they get what they want.

Discipline should focus on teaching a lesson to help toddlers develop a sense of autonomy. Taking the time at this stage to make sure that children understand why certain behaviors are unacceptable helps them to both realize what's expected of them and improve their self-control. Architect parents also benefit by improving their relationships with their children by becoming sources of thoughtful wisdom, rather than of anger and frustration.

Practicing Patience and Flexibility

Rarely, if ever, are toddlers behaving in negative ways out of malice or conscious disrespect for their parents. Arguments and lies from children at this stage are generally the results of children wanting to be understood or to avoid getting in trouble. With their limited ability to communicate their thoughts and feelings, toddlers act out in ways that defy adult, especially Architect, logic. If Architect parents fail to see this behavior in the context of development and instead let their irritation get the best of them, they may resort to punishment. Improving their patience is key for Architects who are looking to address their toddlers' behavior in positive and productive ways – but this is certainly easier said than done.

Patience improves when parents can adapt and be flexible based on their children's changing needs and abilities. Flexibility can be rather elusive for Architects, but fortunately, it's a skill they can develop just

like any other. Being an especially unpredictable stage, toddlerhood provides infinite opportunities to practice the patience and flexibility these parents need to navigate parenthood effectively. Specifically, Architects can try the following actions when they feel they're losing patience with their toddlers:

- Stop and breathe. Whatever is taking place, whether it's a temper tantrum or a potty-training setback, step back from the situation and take 10 deep breaths.
- Take a moment to remember that children at this stage aren't behaving negatively out of spite or as a personal attack.
- Consider children's points of view in these situations – perhaps they're sleepy, hungry, overwhelmed, misunderstood, or just plain frustrated.
- Think about what can be done to turn such situations into "wins" for both parties. Maybe the little one could use a nap, which would also give you some quiet time. Perhaps you both could have a nice snack together.

Thirst for Knowledge (3–5 Years)

The preschool years, from approximately 3–5 years of age, are a prime time for brain development, and children at this stage accumulate knowledge at an extraordinary rate. Children absorb information like sponges through constant activity and a seemingly infinite stream of disparate questions. Learning at this stage takes place through play, especially the unstructured and imaginary kind, and lots of social interaction with family and peers. Creativity is also exercised extensively through make-believe games and stories.

When children don't have the opportunity to practice initiating activities – or are made to feel as though their constant questions or childish make-believe games are annoying – they can experience feelings of guilt, frustration, and a lack of competence. Consequently, they may suffer from poor self-control or a lack of initiative. To navigate this stage successfully, Architect parents must give their children the opportunity to make some of their own decisions and allow them to initiate activities, ask questions, receive answers, and lead others in exploration play.

Balanced Preschool Parenting

Competent Mentors

Architects are often imaginative, determined, quick-witted, and decisive individuals who excel at making plans and solving problems. They have no problem modeling these behaviors, and they are likely to encourage their preschoolers to both initiate and engage in imaginative play, as well as practice creative problem-solving through activities like board games and puzzles. As previously mentioned, Architect parents encourage learning and often gladly answer their children's incessant stream of questions. In fact, these parents take great pleasure in explaining concepts, especially complicated ones, and enjoy their role as informers.

Instilling a sense of curiosity, independent thinking, and high personal standards into their children from a young age is just as important to Architect parents as any set of skills. They encourage their preschoolers to view every situation as a learning opportunity. Something as simple as a walk around the neighborhood can be an impromptu lesson on nature and geography, and trips to the grocery store can evolve into engaging math practice. People with this personality type prompt their children to question everything, for better or worse, and they try to instill curiosity and a love of learning from an early age.

Promoting Confidence

In addition to providing endless information and learning opportunities for their preschoolers, Architect parents model independent thinking skills that also promote confidence. If kids at this stage lack confidence in themselves, they can become overly dependent on others to lead, inform, or motivate them. Architect parents don't support this type of passivity; instead, they focus on helping their children feel confident and capable enough in their abilities to make choices on their own and take the initiative to learn and try new things.

Architects have well-developed decision-making skills and incredible initiative – both qualities that are vital for preschoolers to learn. Self-assured Architect parents actively encourage their children to develop their own critical thinking skills. At this stage, for example, they might expect their children to use their problem-solving skills

to deal with other kids who are difficult to get along with. They're unlikely to pander to their preschoolers' desire to have issues solved for them, preferring to work with their children to figure out age-appropriate solutions.

Unbalanced Preschool Parenting

Social Graces Optional

Some of the behaviors Architects model may not always be positive or productive. Efficiency is often more important to them than empathy, and some parents may avoid teaching their children how to communicate with compassion or tact. Architect parents are often more interested in seeing their children succeed than in helping them to develop positive relationships with others. For example, they may enthusiastically cheer on their kids as they score goals during their soccer games, ignoring the fact that they weren't trying to pass the ball to other children on the team. If these parents believe that winning is the only way to achieve success, they may lose sight of skills like teamwork and sportsmanship.

This tendency toward insensitivity influences Architects' interactions with their children. Even the most loving Architect parents may react in harsh or critical ways when their young children upset them. Preschoolers are especially sensitive to criticism, and frequent, harsh confrontations may provoke feelings of guilt that are difficult to overcome. Hearing that their questions are "annoying" or "dumb" can be crushing during this phase, and kids may begin to feel as though they're an unimportant inconvenience to their parents, setting the stage for future resentment.

Excessively Logical

Some Architect parents fall flat when it comes to truly embracing unstructured or creative play. Those who fixate on their children's intellectual development may fall prey to the idea that free play isn't as valuable as "educational" play or more intentional learning activities. They may focus their energy on providing learning experiences, rather than allowing their little ones to take the lead. A love of efficient, strategic learning taken too far may leave too little room for children

to make discoveries – and even important mistakes – necessary for developing competence and initiative.

An excessively logical approach that completely discounts their feelings is unlikely to provide for children's needs at any age, but this is especially true with preschoolers, whose behaviors revolve around their often-unregulated emotions. Sensitive little ones are even more likely to react with temper tantrums, perhaps even refusing to engage with others out of fear of rejection. Architects who are unable or unwilling to connect with their preschoolers on an emotional level because they fail to see the logic behind that approach may struggle to instill the confidence their kids need to become self-assured, competent adults.

Rebalancing Preschool Parenting

Increasing Compassion and Understanding

For Architect parents to support their children's self-confidence and teach them healthy social skills, they need to practice compassion and understanding themselves. Criticism is especially damaging to kids who, at this stage, are just beginning to develop confidence in their abilities and the initiative necessary to pursue further learning of their own accord.

To prevent the guilt and withdrawal that may evolve when children constantly feel as though they're wrong, parents need to reassess how they communicate with their preschoolers. Are they modeling compassionate communication? Are they patient when engaging in stressful conversations, or do they quickly become critical? Do they promote empathetic behaviors such as concern when someone is sad, angry, or hurt? Or do they tend to avoid other people when they're expressing emotions? If they find they aren't communicating in ways that model compassion or understanding, Architects can try the following activity:

- First, consider a situation that triggers an angry or critical response, such as your preschooler frequently ignoring you when you ask them to pick up their toys.

- Next, think about the "default" response that occurs in this situation.
  - Is there yelling?
  - Are threats made to take away (or throw away) toys that aren't picked up?
  - Are threats made about possibly sending the children to time-out?
  - Are the kids told that they're lazy, disrespectful, or naughty?
- Now, write down what it is about that behavior that elicits an angry or critical response.
  - Are there feelings of disrespect on your part?
  - Do you feel that your child doesn't like you?
  - Is there an underlying concern that the child is just plain "bad?"
- Instead of taking your child's behavior personally, consider ways to respond to these situations with understanding. In our example, the child may not want to pick up their toys because they're having too much fun, or they may be very tired.
- Respond in a way that addresses the behavior with compassion rather than frustration.
  - "I know you're tired, but we need to pick up the toys before you lie down. Here, let me help you."
  - "I know you're having fun, but we must go to the grocery store, so we need to pick the toys up now. Don't worry, you can play with them again when we get home!"

Understanding is the root of compassion, so taking the time to figure out what their preschoolers' real intentions are gives Architect parents the opportunity to connect with their children in intentional, meaningful ways.

Promoting Creative Play

Learning to gauge their children's developmental readiness can be

difficult for Architects focused on achievement. Rather than constantly worrying about where their kids currently fall on the bell curve, Architect parents can focus on allowing them to develop organically. Children don't need "educational" toys and games or a rigid itinerary of structured learning periods throughout the day. Playing with simple toys "on demand" allows them to engage their imagination, the first building block for constructive growth.

But being flexible doesn't have to mean all play and no work. One way that Architect parents can promote both learning and autonomy without being overly controlling is to allow their preschoolers to engage in imaginative, unstructured play. Playing house, pretending to be dinosaurs (perhaps with improvised costumes), making up silly stories, or even playing a game of "hide-and-seek" can model the benefits of play and enhance the parent-child bond. Unstructured play time is vitally important for children at this stage to gain competence, confidence, and initiative. Here are some ideas for unstructured, child-led play that Architect parents can include in their plans for the day:

- A game of "Simon Says," where the children take the lead telling their parents what to do.
- Play that involves building or creating something from scratch, such as building with blocks, molding with clay, creating paper crafts, coloring, or painting.
    - Consider setting these up in a place where messes can be contained.
- Outdoor play with natural items such as sticks, stones, dirt, and water, which promotes creativity and imagination in ways that structured play and video games cannot.

Encouraging free, unstructured play doesn't mean that Architect parents can't promote educational play or learning activities as well. The key is finding a balance between structured activities and the freedom that children at this stage need to develop initiative and self-confidence.

Creating Competence (5–12 Years)

The early school years are an important period of skill development for young children. Not only are they still continually absorbing new information, but they're also working on becoming proficient in increasingly complex areas, from relationships to mathematics to athletics. Children who are both challenged and supported in these areas flourish in their abilities as well as their self-confidence.

If they don't receive consistent support, kids at this stage can begin to feel inferior to their peers, and they may be less likely to develop long-term goals or work toward achieving them. On the other hand, if they aren't sufficiently challenged, they can start to feel overly confident in themselves and their abilities, perhaps lacking modesty and compassion toward others.

Balanced School-Age Parenting

Encouraging Expertise

As parents, Architects have no trouble challenging their children to improve themselves and to set and achieve increasingly ambitious goals, though those goals may not always take expected forms. Becoming expert in any field is of utmost importance to Architects, and they tend to take every opportunity to promote their children's desire to increase their knowledge and skills. Are their kids passionate about dinosaurs? Parents with this personality type are likely to provide books, educational videos, and museum trips galore.

Not ones to settle for merely "learning about something," Architect parents place a great deal of emphasis on developing competence. They work tirelessly to inspire their children to build skills and abilities, especially in their intellectual development. Although Architects prize intelligence, they're no strangers to hard work, and they encourage children of all levels and abilities to achieve their personal best.

Supporting, Setting, and Achieving Goals

Setting and achieving goals are skills that children at this stage are learning to do, and Architect parents are happy to model the focus and determination needed to succeed. School-aged children face increasing

expectations in terms of attaining skills and knowledge, and they benefit from parents who can teach them how to strategically meet such expectations. Parents with this personality type find great joy in sitting down with their kids to help them figure out what steps they must take to achieve their academic, social, and personal objectives.

Developing long-term goals is challenging for children who can't effectively engage in future planning. This skill becomes increasingly necessary during the school-age years, and Architect parents can draw on their own experience with planning and setting goals to help their sons and daughters prepare for projects. ("OK, you want to make a solar-powered toilet for the science fair? Let's figure out what you need and what the time frame is so that you can make the best toilet possible.") They can also provide them with the resources necessary to achieve specific goals. ("You want to make the swim team this year? Great! I'll get you a membership for the pool so you can practice.")

Unbalanced School-Age Parenting

Unrelenting Perfectionism

Architects can become so focused on being successful and doing things perfectly that they may unintentionally erode their children's confidence with unrelenting streams of criticism, such as, "There's no excuse for less-than-perfect grades – anything less than an 'A' in Language Arts is completely unacceptable." (In fact, Architects with this perspective subject themselves to the same scrutiny and incessant judgment, resulting in bitterness and frustration when they don't meet their own unrealistic expectations.)

When these perfectionist tendencies are carried over into their parenting, they may find themselves subconsciously expecting negative outcomes when they interact with their children. When assuming the worst becomes their default mode, Architect parents inadvertently set up their kids for failure. Telling their children, "Don't bother with getting your paints out. You're just going to make a mess, anyway," is discouraging to kids with a budding interest in art. Nipping too many buds can place children and parents alike in "no win" situations that result in stalled development for the kids – and frustration for everyone involved.

Overwhelming Expectations

It's also possible for Architects to push this achievement-oriented view on unwilling children – who may be more interested in building meaningful relationships than becoming stars of the basketball team or valedictorian of their class. Constant pressure to accomplish ever-higher levels of success can overwhelm sensitive children at this stage, making them feel both inadequate and unworthy of their parents' love. Architect parents who take a tough-love approach in such situations may do much more harm than good to their children's already fluctuating self-esteem.

Sensitive kids may be especially overwhelmed by their Architect parents' expectations. Children who feel constant pressure and very little support either become withdrawn, pulling away from the people and situations causing the pressure, or begin to act out, expressing their frustration in unhealthy ways. Although the pressure they place on their sons and daughters may be well-intentioned, Architects who don't consider their children's emotional needs may inadvertently damage their relationships.

Rebalancing School-Age Parenting

Becoming an Active Listener

It's important for these parents to balance their obsession with perfection with compassion and support. Peers and teachers exert an increasing influence on school-age children, but parents still have the lead role in helping develop their skills, goals, and, ultimately, self-esteem. Architects who struggle with overly perfectionist tendencies or competitive natures need to take steps to decrease their criticism and focus on empathizing with their children. As ambitious as they are, and as successful as they hope their children can be, they must learn to temper their motivation with compassion.

Active listening is one of the most effective ways to practice compassion. The following steps can help Architect parents to develop active listening skills to communicate with their children in more compassionate, effective ways:

- Take time to listen to children's concerns, questions, and frustrations without focusing exclusively on how to solve their problems.
- Once you have taken time to improve your understanding of a situation, focus on working with your child to help them find solutions (if necessary).
- Keep in mind, it's also incredibly important for parents to practice non-judgment when actively listening to children. Listening is more important than providing an opinion in most circumstances – an important skill to learn when communicating with children and adults alike.

Focusing on Holistic Development

Challenging their children to improve is a worthy goal for all parents, but constantly pushing them to exceed their limits is likely to cause more harm than good. Kids' confidence decreases when they believe they aren't meeting their parents' expectations, causing them to either withdraw or act out in frustration. Architects who believe they're doing their children a favor by pushing them to succeed may be in for a rude awakening when they find out they're pushing them away.

Architect parents can learn to balance their expectations with a more holistic approach to their children's growth. Gaining competence is important during this stage, but this means much more than doing well in school, clubs, or sports. School-aged children are spending more time interacting with others outside of their families and developing their own identities, so learning healthy emotional and social intelligence is vital as well. Architects who can appreciate (and assist with) their sons' and daughters' growth in these areas in addition to their intellectual development are more likely to strike a realistic balance in the expectations they have for their children. Here are some ways Architects can work on this:

- Promote (and practice) healthy emotional awareness and expression. Understanding what emotions are being experienced and expressing them properly and effectively are two of the most challenging – and most rewarding – skills parents can learn alongside their children.

- Engaging with empathy. To communicate in an efficient and considerate way, it's essential to look at the situation from others' point of view.
- Practice impulse control. Parents who control their behavior and desires promote self-discipline, one of the most necessary skills for achieving success and building healthy relationships.
- Encourage self-confidence by forgoing criticism and focusing on praising the positive. If criticism is needed, try to balance it out, either in the moment or later, with praise.

Kids thrive when they have the confidence to be themselves. When their lives are in balance, they tend to be happier in the moment, as well as more successful in their future endeavors. Building these skills pays big dividends for children later in life, and it also promotes healthy relationships – including their relationships with their Architect parents.

Find Thyself (12–18 Years)

Adolescence is the transition from childhood to adulthood, when children develop their own distinct identities and prepare for adult independence. This transitional period centers around their roles in relationships with themselves, other people, and society in general. To determine their roles, adolescents begin the all-important process of identifying their personal values and beliefs. This is a time for setting educational and career goals, as well as developing relationships based on ethics and ideals. Adolescence is a pivotal, foundational stage for the rest of their lives.

Balanced Parenting During Adolescence

Encouraging Exploration

As in their toddler years, adolescents find themselves in a transitional stage focused on exploration. This time, however, exploration is focused on the self and identity, rather than external environments. Architect parents who embrace their thirst for knowledge as a tool for personal improvement can be exceptional models for this type of growth.

Parents who embrace their own sense of confidence in implementing their personal visions can also model their passion for learning for their children. Learning new skills and mastering new topics take curiosity and dedication, and motivated Architects have copious amounts of both. Their natural desire to learn and improve is palpable, and their kids witness this behavior on a regular basis. People with this personality type encourage their sons and daughters to explore their interests, regardless of whether those interests are "useful or practical" – and this support can be the confidence boost that adolescents need to pursue their passions.

Promoting a Code of Conduct

During this stage of identity development, teens need the support and understanding of their parents more than ever. One of the most important aspects of personal growth for Architects is their development of a personal "code of conduct," which is used to support various aspects of their identities. Those who remain open to others' perspectives and needs encourage their children to develop their own unique code of conduct as well – one that resonates with them and isn't purely influenced by external factors. If this code of conduct encourages hard work and ambitious goals, Architect parents let their children fill in the blanks to meet their personal requirements and desires.

These parents encourage the development of this code of conduct by promoting and modeling such positive values as efficiency, confidence, and lifelong learning, while providing a supportive environment for their children. They may struggle with gradually decreasing the amount of control they exert over their kids, but Architects are still interested in assisting them in the process of personal development to the best of their ability.

Unbalanced Parenting During Adolescence

Demanding Authoritarians

Parents with an authoritarian bent may struggle with the conflicts that often come with this tumultuous stage of development. Children in this phase of life are grappling with their burgeoning independence

and the responsibilities it entails, and they often need the benefit of understanding conversation to negotiate new expectations. Architects particularly focused on enforcing existing rules may find themselves regularly butting heads with their teens.

There's a significant difference between being *authoritative* as parents (trustworthy, reliable, and considerate) and being an *authoritarian* (someone who focuses on strict obedience to authority regardless of personal circumstance). Architect parents who go overboard with their expectations for their teenagers, expecting unquestioned authority or obedience, often push their growing children away from them in especially damaging ways. Adolescents who feel that their parents disrespect or resent their newfound independence may lack the confidence and motivation to successfully pursue their own personal development.

Overly Judgmental

To kids at this stage, who often already feel constantly judged, critical comments can be devastating, especially regarding their abilities or personal style. The often-fragile sense of self is particularly sensitive for teens coming to terms with who they want to be versus how society views them. Architect parents who constantly move the goal posts for success ("Good thing you passed that test – but next time, shoot for an A.") can undermine their children's self-esteem and, in turn, their relationships.

Constant criticism and reminders of any previous missteps their kids may have made can certainly breed resentment. Rather than forgiving their transgressions and helping their teens deal with the resulting consequences of their actions, overly judgmental Architects may focus on holding those mistakes over their children's heads as reminders of their failures. Often, they believe this is the best way to ensure that their sons and daughters won't repeat their mistakes. Unfortunately, this unconstructive criticism usually strikes recipients as mean and unfair, at a time when children most need understanding and context to help them learn from and eventually overcome their struggles.

Rebalancing Parenting During Adolescence

Adjusting Expectations

As Architect parents learn to navigate their children's changing needs and growing independence, they'll occasionally have to change course. This stage requires a constant rebalancing of responsibility and expectations as adolescents become more capable, responsible, and mature. Parents with the Architect personality type may struggle to lessen the control they exert over their kids – not necessarily because they view them as incapable but, rather, because they genuinely believe themselves to know more. Adolescents are preparing for adulthood and independence, and throughout this stage, their parents' roles evolve from primary caretakers to supportive mentors. Leaving room for flexibility and exploration fosters adolescent children's identity development, making them feel capable of pursuing such a monumentally important task.

Architect parents who wish to encourage their children's personal growth and independence while still maintaining the necessary structure and boundaries for this stage can promote their children's self-discipline. Adolescents who can engage in self-discipline – tapping into their values and knowledge to choose the right decisions, delaying gratification when necessary – are much more likely to be healthy, independent, and successful adults. Authoritative parenting allows children to learn discipline for themselves. One example of how to foster self-discipline is to teach adolescents how to control their emotions (an especially difficult task at this stage.) To do this, Architects can try using the "A-B-C-D-E" method:

- Identify an **A**ctivating event.
  - Example: failing their driver's license test
- Determine the irrational **B**eliefs that resulted from that event.
  - Believing the test was impossible, or they were too stupid to pass it
- Mull over the emotional **C**onsequences of those beliefs.
  - Anger, frustration, and sadness that result in yelling at their parents over a seemingly minor issue

- **D**ispute or challenge the irrational beliefs.
    - Discuss their irrational beliefs that the test was impossible, or that they're stupid, and determine whether it was more likely caused by a lack of study/practice, leading to test anxiety.
- Replace irrational beliefs with new, **E**ffective beliefs that result in positive behaviors.
    - More study/practice before retaking the driver's license test can increase knowledge and improve confidence – hopefully preventing test anxiety and resulting in a passing score.

Adolescents can be walked through this process until they're comfortable practicing it on their own. The idea behind this activity is that older children can learn how to handle their emotions – then build the foundational skills for self-discipline. Architect parents who practice these skills with their children are helping them to develop the tools they need to function most effectively on their own.

Cultivating Positive Communication

Even when they're at their most judgmental, Architect parents are generally caring – they truly want their children to be happy and successful. Hassling their kids for less-than-perfect grades or criticizing their desire to get degrees in fields they deem to be "not viable" ("Art history? That's a hobby, kid.") may demoralize their teens when they intend to be supportive. People with this personality type want what's best for their children, but the way that they communicate this sentiment can become muddled by their personal opinions and "know-it-all" attitude.

The first step to solving this communication problem is realizing that good intentions aren't successfully communicated by criticism or constantly pointing out their children's logical fallacies. Telling adolescent children everything that's wrong with their ideas/beliefs/clothes/taste in music may seem effective, yet a constant focus on the negative can erode both their teens' confidence and the parent-child relationship. Approaching communication in a supportive, positive way, without judgment or condemnation, can improve their rapport and increase their children's confidence and self-determination.

The following tips can help Architects communicate with their adolescent children in a much more positive, productive way:

- Suspend judgment. To prevent potential misunderstandings, don't jump to conclusions or make assumptions about motives, beliefs, or opinions.
- Don't discount feelings. To communicate in honest, open ways, adolescents need to feel as though their parents are considering their feelings.
- Avoid arguing. Nothing escalates a simple conversation to a full-blown fight faster than being combative.
- Speak compassionately. Be intentional about not expressing things in a condescending, angry, or critical way when engaging in a conversation.

Conclusion

Parenting is one of the most challenging experiences that anyone can face, regardless of their personality type. Architects have their own unique strengths – imagination, open-mindedness, determination, and dedication – that they can leverage, as well as weaknesses that they need to understand and work with to build positive, proactive relationships with their children. Parenting presents tremendous potential for personal development, and Architects can gain a much deeper understanding of themselves and others if they use the opportunity to do so.

With that in mind, please remember that the advice provided in this chapter is based on general growth stages for children, as well as basic strengths and weaknesses that many Architects share. All children are different, and parents are the best judges of what their children need. The advice above should be used in a way that works best for each family without adding unmanageable stress, frustration, or burdens. For special situations, such as persistent behavioral or medical issues, consult with professional pediatricians or pediatric psychologists to develop plans that address the needs of everyone involved.

Final Words

Balancing Logic and Emotion

Emotional sensitivity and humility may be challenging for Architects, but their passion for truth and efficacy can help them find balance as they learn to value others' feelings and perspectives. After all, emotions and subjectivity are as much a part of the real world as logic and facts, so it's irrational to deny their power and influence. By increasing their emotional literacy and their appreciation of diverse viewpoints, Architects can become more effective at the work that they feel compelled to do in this world. Beyond that, they can use their emotional intelligence to enhance their friendships, romantic relationships, and family bonds, building a network of trusted friends and loved ones who truly "get" them.

When they feel stuck or face contradictory information, self-realized Architects are unafraid to turn their exacting gaze inward, evaluating whether their opinions and principles could use some updating. Through this type of self-inquiry, these fiercely honest people can recognize when sensitivity and empathy might be more effective than blunt truth-telling – or when they'd be wise to heed their feelings and desires. The capacity to adapt their methods and views as needed is one of the greatest tools for advancement that people with this personality type can practice.

Putting Theory into Action

Above all, Architects must live in authenticity with their true nature – rational but not unfeeling, self-reliant but not isolated. By reflecting on their values and ideals, they can cut past superficial distractions and cultivate the depth that they need to thrive. By developing self-awareness as well as attunement to other people's personalities and needs, Architects can forge relationships that allow them to grow into their best selves and live their best lives.

Fortunately, they are hardly afraid to put theory into action. Drawing on their insight and resolve, they can translate the awareness gained from this e-book into concrete, daily steps. By applying their understanding of personality types, Architects stand to advance their values, strengthen their relationships, and expand their horizons in any directions that they desire.

So... What's Next?

You've reached the end of this book, but fear not – we've created many more resources for you. Here are a few that might capture your interest:

- Want to analyze and improve your relationships with your romantic partner, friends, or children? Explore our Relationships Specialized Tests.
- Looking to set a foundation for learning and developing as a person? Check out the *Architect Guide to Personal Growth*.
- Feeling adrift when it comes to your academic path or your career? Our *Architect Guide to Careers* may be just what you need.

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